

AMERICAN TEEN SLANG

Speak Like a Native

A Complete Guide to Real American English

Speak Like a Native: Your Complete Handbook to Informal English

For High School & ESL Learners

Friendship · School Life · Emotions · Entertainment · Lifestyle

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American Teen Slang: Speak Like a Native

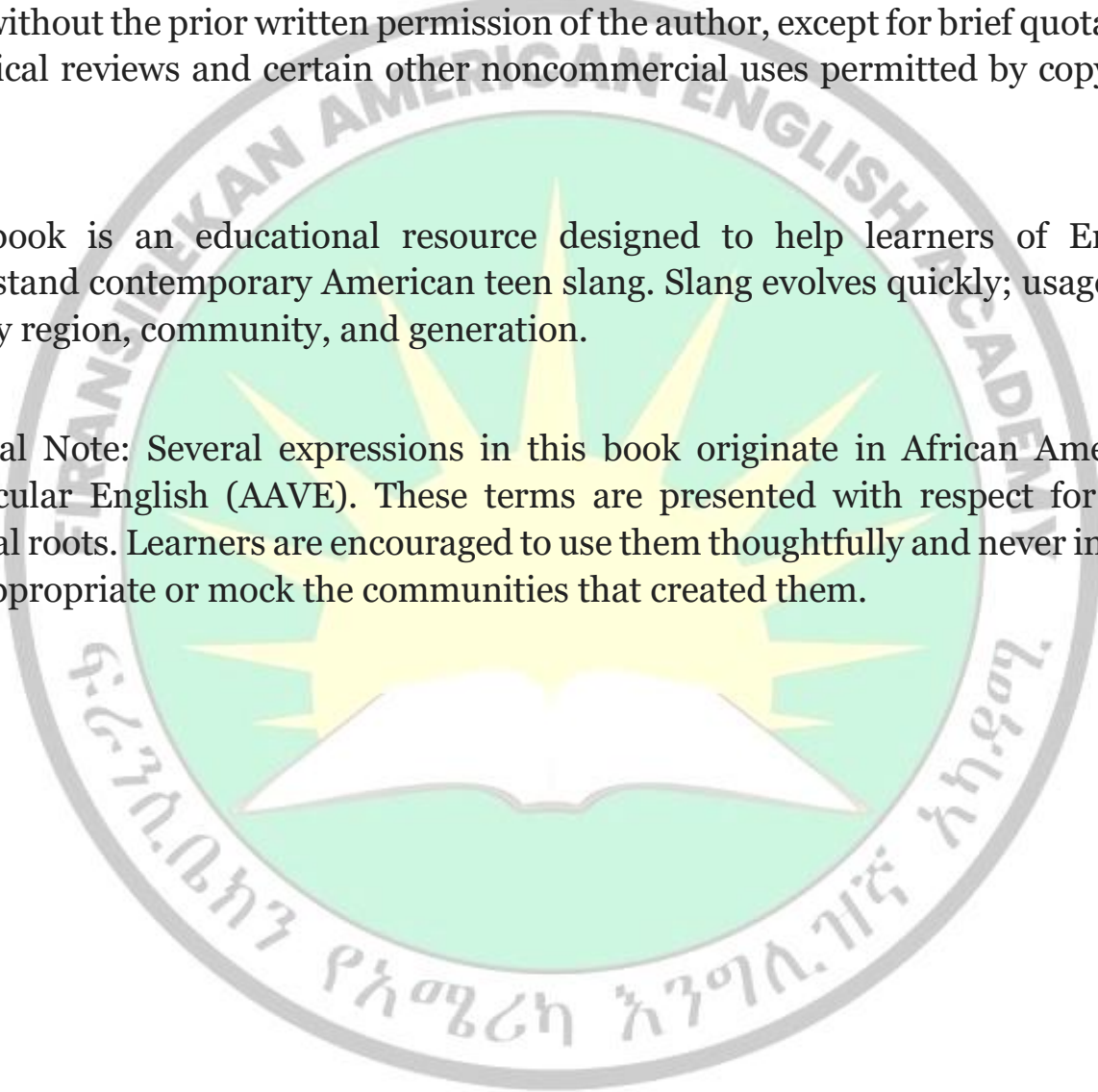
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This book is an educational resource designed to help learners of English understand contemporary American teen slang. Slang evolves quickly; usage may vary by region, community, and generation.

Cultural Note: Several expressions in this book originate in African American Vernacular English (AAVE). These terms are presented with respect for their cultural roots. Learners are encouraged to use them thoughtfully and never in ways that appropriate or mock the communities that created them.



Acknowledgements

I would like to express my deepest gratitude to everyone who made this book possible.

First and foremost, I thank my teacher, Mr. Ana's Jibril, for his endless support, guidance, and encouragement throughout this project. His passion for teaching and his dedication to helping students master the English language have been a true inspiration. Without his wisdom and patience, this book would not exist.

I am also incredibly grateful to all the teachers at Fransibekan American English School. Your commitment to excellence and your belief in your students have shaped the way I understand and appreciate the English language. Thank you for creating such a supportive and inspiring learning environment.

To every student who will open these pages—I wrote this for you. I know how challenging it can be to understand the way Americans really speak. Slang can feel like a secret code, and it's easy to feel lost or left out. I wanted to create a guide that makes slang simple, clear, and genuinely fun to learn.

Thank you to my family and friends who supported me along the way. Your encouragement kept me going.

And finally, thank you to every learner who picks up this book. Your curiosity and determination inspire me. Keep going, keep practicing, and never stop believing in yourself.

You got this, fam!

With gratitude,

Yasin Awal Hasan

How to Use This Book

This is not a dictionary you memorize from A to Z. It is a practical speaking guide. Here is the best way to get the most from it.

1. Start with what interests you

You do not need to read cover to cover on day one. Love music and gaming? Jump to Topic 4: Entertainment. Obsessed with fashion and food? Go to Topic 5: Lifestyle. Follow your curiosity—motivation is the best teacher.

2. Learn with a partner

Slang is social. Practice the dialogues out loud with a friend, classmate, or language partner. Test each other, role-play the scenes, and laugh at the mistakes. You will learn faster and remember longer.

3. Say it out loud—every time

Slang is spoken language. Reading silently is not enough. Speak the words, the short forms, and the full dialogues. Practice in your room, in the shower, walking to school. The more your mouth moves, the more natural the language becomes.

4. Notice the four focus areas in every chapter

Each topic follows the same clear structure so you always know where you are:

- Meaning – exact definitions, examples, and cultural notes
- Informal Conversation – how the words are actually used with friends
- Pronunciation – how to sound natural, not robotic
- Real-Life Speaking – full dialogues and role-plays you can act out

5. Do the exercises

Every chapter ends with practice activities. Complete them. Check the answer keys. Then create your own examples. Active use is what turns recognition into real speaking ability.

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Slang Don'ts – What to Avoid

Not every “cool” word is appropriate. Some language is harmful; other words simply sound outdated or forced. Use this short list as a permanent filter.

Never use

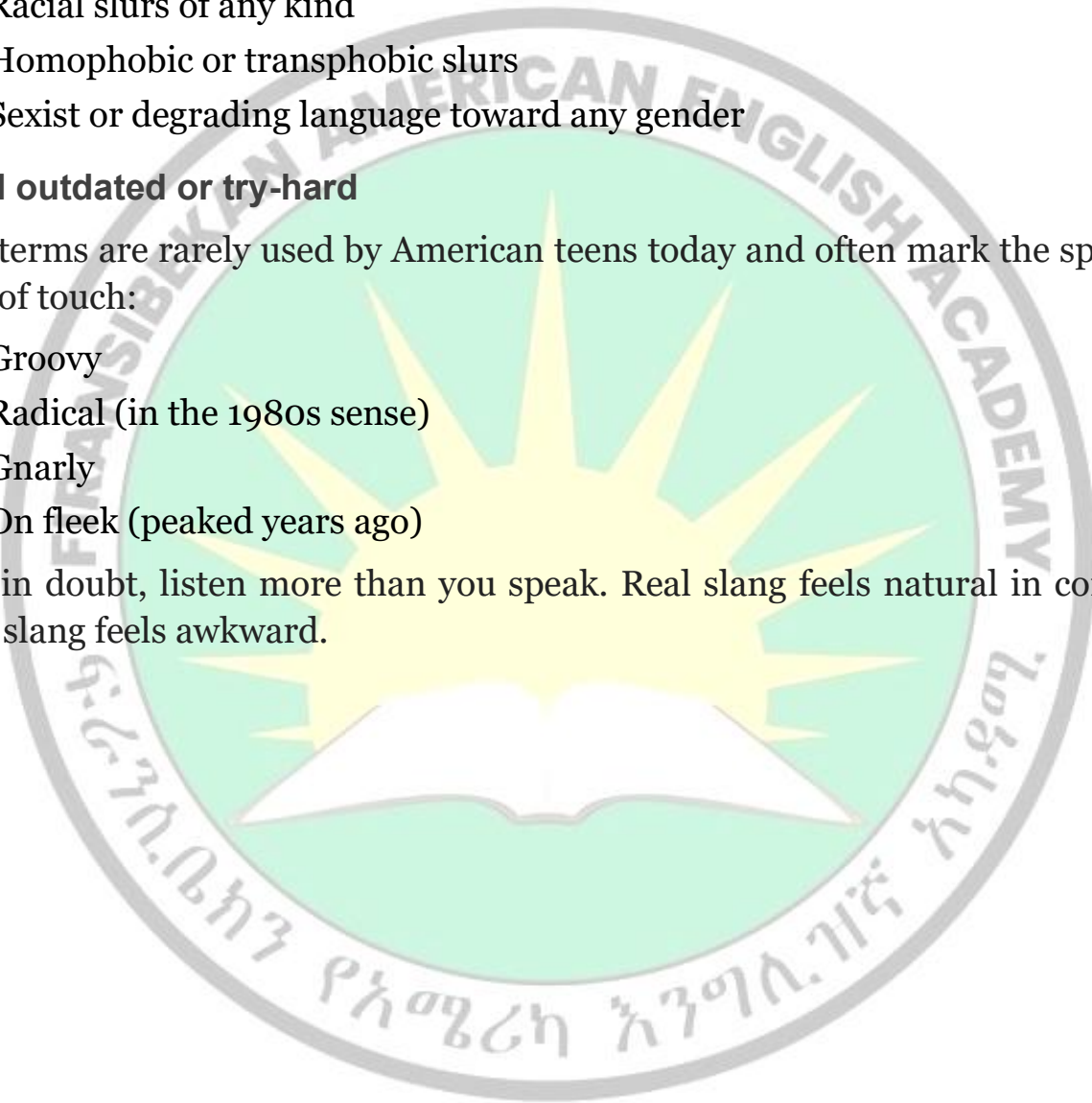
- Racial slurs of any kind
- Homophobic or transphobic slurs
- Sexist or degrading language toward any gender

Sound outdated or try-hard

These terms are rarely used by American teens today and often mark the speaker as out of touch:

- Groovy
- Radical (in the 1980s sense)
- Gnarly
- On fleek (peaked years ago)

When in doubt, listen more than you speak. Real slang feels natural in context; forced slang feels awkward.



CHAPTER 1: Friendship

Your Crew, Your Fam

Friendship is one of the most important parts of teenage life. Your friends are the people you laugh with, cry with, and make memories with. They are your support system, your partners in crime, and the people who make school actually bearable.

In America, teens have dozens of special words to talk about their friends. These words show closeness, loyalty, and belonging. When you use them correctly, you are not just speaking English—you are showing that you understand the social code.

In this topic you will learn how to:

- Talk about your best friends and your group
- Greet friends the way American teens actually do
- Compliment and support your friends
- Cheer up a friend who is having a hard day
- Playfully tease without crossing the line
- Text your BFF like a native speaker

Area 1 · Meaning

1.1 Words for Close Friends

BFF

Meaning: Best Friends Forever. Your number-one, absolute best friend the person you tell everything to and who knows you better than anyone else.

Example: She's been my BFF since third grade.

Example: "She's my BFF. We've known each other since kindergarten."

Cultural Note: This is one of the most common abbreviations in American English, especially among younger people. It shows a deep, lasting bond.

Bestie

Meaning: Short for “best friend.” Your closest friend, the one you do almost everything with. Your best friend (short and cute version of BFF).

Example: I'm meeting my bestie after school.

Example: "Hey bestie! I missed you so much!"

When to use it: Use this with your closest friend. It shows affection and warmth.

Fam

Meaning: Close friends who feel like family. People you trust the way you trust brothers or sisters.

Example: These are my fam I trust them with anything.

Note: This word comes from AAVE. Use it with respect.

Squad

Meaning: Your group of close friends usually three to six people who always hang out together. Like a small team.

Example: The whole squad is coming to the movie.

Homie

Meaning: A close, trusted friend. Can be used for male or female friends. A close friend. Someone you trust and feel comfortable with.

Example: He's my homie from way back.

Example: "He's my homie. We've got each other's backs."

Origin: This word comes from "homeboy" or "homegirl," which originally referred to someone from your neighborhood. Now it means any close friend.

Ride or Die

Meaning: A loyal friend who sticks with you through anything good times and bad. Someone who will never abandon you.

Example: She's my ride-or-die. Always has been.

Example: "She's my ride or die. I know she'll always have my back."

Usage: This is a very strong term. Only use it for your absolute most loyal friends.

Bro

Meaning: A male friend, or anyone you feel close to. Often used casually with guys, but can be used more widely among close friends (can be used for girls too, but it's usually for guys). It shows casual closeness.

Example: Thanks for the help, bro.

Example: "What's up, bro? How was your weekend?"

Usage: Very common among teenagers and young adults. It's casual and friendly.

Quick Review Table

Quick Reference Table: Best Friend Words

Slang	Simple Meaning
BFF	Your very best friend forever
Bestie	Your best friend (short and warm)
Fam	Friends who feel like family
Squad	Your group of close friends
Homie	A close, trusted friend
Ride or Die	A loyal friend through everything
Bro	A male friend or close buddy

1.2 Words for Your Group

Crew

Meaning: Your group of friends. Similar to “squad,” a bit more casual.

Example: My crew is meeting at the park.

Example: "I'm hanging out with my crew tonight."

Clan

Meaning: Your tight group of friends—almost like a family or tribe.

Example: We're a small clan, but we're solid.

Example: "My clan always sticks together."

Cultural Note: This word makes your friend group sound like a family very close and loyal.

Squad

Meaning: Your group of close friends.

Example: "My squad is meeting at the mall at 4."

Usage: This is a very popular word. Use it to refer to your main friend group.

1.3 Loyalty Words

I got your back

Meaning: I will protect and support you. You can count on me.

Example: Don't worry about the presentation, I got your back.

Example: "Don't worry about those bullies. I got your back."

Pronunciation: Often said as "I gotchu" in fast speech.

On God

Meaning: I swear; I'm telling the absolute truth.

Example: On God, I didn't tell anyone.

Example: "On God, I didn't take your phone!"

Cultural Note: This comes from African American Vernacular English (AAVE). Be respectful when using it. It expresses strong sincerity.

Note: Originates in AAVE. Use respectfully.

No Cap

Meaning: No lie; for real; I'm being honest.

Example: "That movie was amazing, no cap!"

Usage: "Cap" means lie. So "no cap" means "no lie."

For Real

Meaning: Seriously; truly; I mean it.

Example: "Are you for real? You actually got tickets?"

1.4 Different Types of Friends

The Hype Man / Hype Person

Meaning: The friend who always cheers everyone on, gets people excited, and builds others up.

Example: She's the hype person of the group—always lifting us up.

Example: "Mike is such a hype man. He made me feel so confident before the game."

The Plug

Meaning: The friend who always knows where to get things food, tickets, information, connections.

Example: Ask Jordan. He's the plug for concert tickets.

Example: "I need a ride to the concert. I'll ask James, he's the plug."

The Mom Friend

Meaning: The responsible friend who takes care of everyone.

Example: "Sarah is the mom friend. She always brings snacks and first aid."

The Therapist Friend

Meaning: The friend everyone goes to for advice and emotional support.

Example: "I always tell my problems to Emma. She's the therapist friend."

Area 2 · Informal Conversation

2.1 Cool Greetings

When you see your friends, avoid formal “Hello, how are you?” That can sound stiff or teacher-like. Use these instead:

What’s up? / Wassup?

Meaning: The most common casual greeting among American teens. Use it any time you see a friend.

When to use it: Any time you see a friend. It's the most common greeting in America!

Example: "What's up, bro? Haven't seen you in forever!"

Example: *Wassup, fam?*

Response: "Hey, what's up?"

Sup?

Meaning: Short for “What’s up?” Very casual; best with close friends.

When to use it: Use it with close friends.

Example: *Sup, bestie?*

Response: "Sup!"-

Yo

Meaning: A quick, energetic greeting or attention-getter.

Example: *Yo, you coming or what?*

Example: "Yo! Wait up!"

What’s good?

Meaning: Another friendly greeting, similar to “What’s up?”

Example: *What’s good, bro?*

Example: "What's good, fam? How was your weekend?"

Greetings Quick Reference

Greetings	When to Use
What's up?	Any time with friends
Sup?	Very casual with close friends
Yo!	Getting attention or casual greeting
What's good?	Asking about news/plans

2.2 How to Compliment Your Friends

American teens love hyping each other up. Genuine compliments strengthen the group.

Here's how to give compliments like a native:

You slay!

Meaning: You look amazing or you did something incredible.

Example: That outfit? You slay.

Example: "You slay in that dress! Where did you get it?"

"You're the best!"

Meaning: You're amazing; I appreciate you.

Example: "Thanks for helping me study. You're the best!"

Facts

Meaning: That's completely true. I agree 100%.

Example: "She's the best teacher." – "Facts."

Example: "This pizza is the best in town." "Facts!"

"Slay!"

Meaning: Do something incredibly well; look amazing.

Example: "You slayed that presentation!"

"I see you!"

Meaning: I notice you looking good / doing well.

Example: "I see you with that new haircut!"

No cap

Meaning: No lie; I'm being completely honest.

Example: No cap, that was the best game all year.

2.3 How to Cheer Up a Friends

Sometimes your friends have bad days. Here's how to show you care using slang:

You good?

Meaning: Are you okay? A caring check-in when someone seems quiet, sad, or upset.

When to use it: When a friend seems sad, quiet, or upset.

Example: "Hey, you've been quiet all day. You good?"

Example: Hey, you've been quiet all day. You good?

Response: "Yeah, I'm good. Just tired."

You got this

Meaning: You can do it; I believe in you. Encouragement when a friend is nervous or facing a challenge.

When to use it: When a friend is nervous and needs encouragement.

Example: "Nervous about the presentation? You got this, bro!"

Example: *Nervous about the test? You got this.*

"Chill out" Meaning: Relax; don't stress.

Example: "Chill out, bro. Everything will be fine."

I'm here for you

Meaning: You can count on me. I'm available to support you.

Example: *Whatever you need, I'm here for you. Always.*

"It's all good."

Meaning: Everything is okay; don't worry.

Example: "I know you forgot to call. It's all good."

2.4 Playful Teasing

Friends tease each other in a loving way. Tone and relationship matter—never use these to genuinely hurt someone. Here are some fun phrases:

You're trippin'

Meaning: You're being ridiculous or you're wrong about something.

Example: *You think she's mad at you? You're trippin'.*

Example: "You think that movie was bad? You're trippin'!"

Extra

Meaning: Over-the-top, dramatic, or doing too much.

Example: *Three different outfits for one party? So extra.*

Example: "You bought 10 different outfits for one party? You're so extra!"

Savage

Meaning: Harsh but funny; brutally honest in a bold way.

Example: *That comeback was savage.*

Example: "She told him he was wrong in front of everyone. Savage!"

"Sit down!"

Meaning: Calm down; stop being dramatic.

Example: "You think you're better than me? Sit down!"

2.5 Texting Your BFF – Essential Abbreviations

Americans LOVE abbreviations when texting. Here are the most common ones:

Common Text Abbreviations

Slang	Simple Meaning	Example
BRB	Be right back	"BRB getting water."
IDK	I don't know	"IDK what to wear tonight."
LOL	Laughing out loud	"That meme is so funny LOL."
OMG	Oh my god	"OMG did you see what happened?"
SMH	Shaking my head	"He forgot our plans again. SMH."
TBH	To be honest	"TBH I don't really like that song."
RN	Right now	"I'm busy RN talk later."
G2G / GTG	Got to go	"G2G my mom is calling."
TTYL	Talk to you later	"I have to go. TTYL!"
IKR	I know, right?	"That movie was so good!" "IKR!"

School & daily life additions

All-nighter

Meaning: Staying up the entire night to study or finish work.

Example: "I pulled an all-nighter for that essay."

Skip / Cut class

Meaning: Intentionally miss a class.

Example: "We skipped last period and got caught."

Social media additions

Finsta

Meaning: "Fake Instagram" — a private account for close friends only.

Example: "I'll post the real photos on my finsta."

Ratio / Ratioed

Meaning: When a reply gets more likes than the original post (public disagreement or mockery).

Example: "He got ratioed so hard."

Shadowban

Meaning: When a platform quietly limits the reach of your content.

Example: "I think I got shadowbanned."

Slide into DMs

Meaning: Send a private message, often with romantic or opportunistic intent.

Example: "He slid into my DMs last night."

Algo / Algorithm

Meaning: The system that decides what content you see.

Example: "The algo is not showing my posts."

Romance & relationship additions

Situationship

Meaning: Romantic or sexual connection that lacks clear definition or commitment.

Example: "It's just a situationship — nothing official."

Breadcrumb / Breadcrumbing

Meaning: Give just enough attention to keep someone interested without real commitment.

Example: "He's only breadcrumbing you."

Catch feelings

Meaning: Start developing real romantic emotions, sometimes unexpectedly.

Example: "I wasn't trying to catch feelings."

Soft launch

Meaning: Subtly show a new partner on social media (blurry photo, partial face, etc.).

Example: "They soft-launched last month."

Hard launch

Meaning: Openly and clearly post a new partner on social media.

Example: "They hard-launched yesterday with a full couple photo."

Mindset & peer-pressure additions

Main character energy

Meaning: Acting or feeling like the confident protagonist of a story.

Example: "She's giving main character energy today."

NPC

Meaning: Someone who seems to have no independent personality or agency (from gaming “non-player character”).

Example: "He just stands there like an NPC."

Touch grass

Meaning: Go outside / spend less time online (playful criticism).

Example: "You need to touch grass."

Quick view — new youth-life terms

New Slang	Meaning
Finsta	Private Instagram for close friends
Ratio / Ratioed	Reply gets more likes than original
Shadow ban	Quietly limited reach
Situationship	Undefined romantic connection
Breadcrumbing	Minimal attention to keep interest
Soft / Hard launch	Subtle vs open partner reveal
Main character energy	Confident protagonist vibe
NPC	No independent personality
Touch grass	Log off / go outside

Area 3 · Pronunciation Practice Sentences

Sounding Natural, Not Robotic

Americans connect words and reduce sounds. Practice these patterns out loud.

“What’s up?” becomes “Wassup?” — pronounced roughly WUH-sup.

“I got your back” often becomes “I gotchu” or “I gotcha.”

“Going to” → “gonna” · “Want to” → “wanna” · “Got to” → “gotta” · “Let me” → “lemme”

Practice sentences (say each five times):

1. Wassup, bro? You good?
2. I gotchu, fam. Always.
3. Sup, bestie? Wanna hang?
4. My crew is so lit!
5. You’re my ride-or-die, for real, no cap.

Area 4 · Real-Life Speaking

Dialogue 1 – Greeting Your Squad at School

Setting: Monday morning, high school hallway.

Jake: Yo, what’s good, fam?

Mia: Sup, Jake! You good? You look tired.

Jake: Yeah, I’m kinda wiped. Weekend was too lit. I didn’t sleep much.

Mia: Facts! That party on Saturday was crazy.

Jake: No cap. I’m still recovering.

Mia: Who else is coming today?

Jake: The whole squad. We’re meeting at lunch.

Mia: Bet. I’ll be there. Save me a seat.

Jake: Always, bestie. I gotchu.

Dialogue 2: Meeting Up

Setting: Two friends see each other at school.

Maya: "Wassup, bestie! I haven't seen you all day!"

Jamal: "Yo, Maya! I know, right? I had a test in history."

Maya: "For real? How'd it go? You good?"

Jamal: "I think so. It wasn't too bad. But I'm so tired."

Maya: "Same. I stayed up studying. I'm wiped."

Jamal: "Wanna grab some lunch? I'm starving."

Maya: "Bet! Let's go to the cafeteria. My squad is saving us a table."

Jamal: "Lit! Let's bounce."

Dialogue 3 – Texting Conversation

Emma: OMG, guess what???

Sophia: What?? Tell me RN!

Emma: I got tickets to the Taylor Swift concert!

Sophia: STOP PLAYING! For real???

Emma: No cap! My cousin works at the venue and she got us VIP!

Sophia: OMG I'm literally crying. I can't even! I'm so stoked!

Dialogue 4: Texting Your Best Friend

Text Conversation:

Aisha: "OMG! You won't believe what happened!"

Sarah: "What?? Tell me RN!"

Aisha: "I got the lead in the school play!"

Sarah: "NO WAY! For real?! That's fire!"

Aisha: "No cap! I'm so stoked!"

Sarah: "I'm so proud of you, bestie! You slay!"

Aisha: "Thanks! I couldn't have done it without you."

Sarah: "Stop. You did it all yourself. You're the best!"

Aisha: "I gotta go. My mom is calling. TTYL!"

Sarah: "G2G too. Talk later! ❤️ "

Dialogue 5: Cheering Up a Friend

Setting: After school, on the bleachers.

Carlos: "What's up, man? You look down."

Derek: "I'm just... stressed, you know? I failed my math test."

Carlos: "Ah, that's rough, bro. But you got this. It's just one test."

Derek: "I studied so hard though. I feel like I'm trippin'."

Carlos: "Chill out. It happens to everyone. You'll do better next time."

Derek: "I guess. I just feel so bummed."

Carlos: "I'm here for you, fam. We can study together if you want."

Derek: "Really? That would help a lot. Thanks, bro."

Carlos: "Anytime. You're my ride or die, remember? I gotchu."

Derek: (smiling) "You're the best, man. For real."

Dialogue 4: Playful Teasing

Setting: Friends hanging out at the park.

Jenna: "I can't believe you wore that shirt. It's so basic."

Marcus: "It's not basic! It's a classic!"

Jenna: "Nah, you're trippin'. It's so old."

Marcus: "Whatever. You're just jealous of my drip."

Jenna: "Your drip? That's not drip. That's... something else."

Marcus: "Savage. You're so savage today."

Jenna: "I'm just keeping it real, bro."

Marcus: "Facts. I can't even be mad. You're funny."

Practice Dialogue – Act It Out

Role 1: Greet your friend excitedly and ask about the weekend.

Role 2: Respond with slang and describe an amazing weekend.

You: Yo, what's good? How was your weekend?

Friend: It was SO lit! I hung out with the whole squad.

You: No cap? What did you guys do?

Friend: We went to the mall, got some grub, and just chilled.

You: That sounds fire! Why didn't you invite me?

Friend: I texted you! You didn't respond.

You: Wait, for real? I didn't see it. My bad, bro.

Practice Time · Friendship Slang

Exercise 1 – Fill in the Blanks

Complete with the right slang from this chapter.

1. “What’s _____, bro? Haven’t seen you in forever!”
2. “Thanks for helping me move. You’re the _____!”
3. “My _____ is meeting at the movies at 8.”
4. “You look amazing in that dress. You _____!”
5. “I can always count on you. You’re my _____-or-die.”
6. “_____! I totally agree with you.”
7. “I’ll be there at 6, _____.”
8. “Don’t worry, I _____.”
9. “That outfit is so _____! You look great.”
10. “I have to go, my mom is calling. _____!”

Exercise 2 – Respond Like a Native

Write a natural slang response for each situation.

1. Your friend says: “I’m so nervous for my driver’s test tomorrow.”
2. You see your friend after school and want to greet them coolly.
3. Your friend does something really kind for you.
4. You want to agree to go to the movies with your friend.

Exercise 3: Match the Word to Its Meaning

Draw a line from the slang word to its correct meaning:

Slang Word	Meaning
1. BFF	a. Friends who feel like family
2. Fam	b. A group of close friends
3. Squad	c. Best friends forever
4. Homie	d. A close, trusted friend
5. Ride or Die	e. A loyal friend through everything
6. Wassup	f. To be honest
7. TBH	g. Oh my god
8. OMG	h. Laughing out loud
9. LOL	i. What's up?
10. IKR	j. I know, right?

Exercise 4: Create a Text Conversation

Write a 6 message text conversation between two best friends. Use at least 5 slang words or abbreviations from this chapter.

Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____
 Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____
 Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____

Exercise 5: Translate to Teen Slang

Change these formal sentences into teen slang:

1. Formal: "How are you doing today?"
 Slang: _____
2. Formal: "You look very nice in that outfit."
 Slang: _____
3. Formal: "I am going to see my friends now."
 Slang: _____
4. Formal: "Are you okay? You seem sad."
 Slang: _____
5. Formal: "I will support you no matter what."
 Slang: _____

Exercise 6: Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each. Focus on sounding natural, not like a robot!

1. "**Wassup**, bro? You good?"
2. "**I gotchu**, fam. Always."
3. "**Sup**, **bestie**? Wanna hang out later?"
4. "My **crew** is so lit. We always have fun."
5. "You're **my ride or die**, for real, no cap."

Exercise 7: Create Your Own Dialogue

Write a short dialogue between two friends meeting at school. Use at least 8 slang words/phrases from this chapter.

Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____
 Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____
 Friend 1: _____
 Friend 2: _____

Exercise 8– Create a Text Conversation

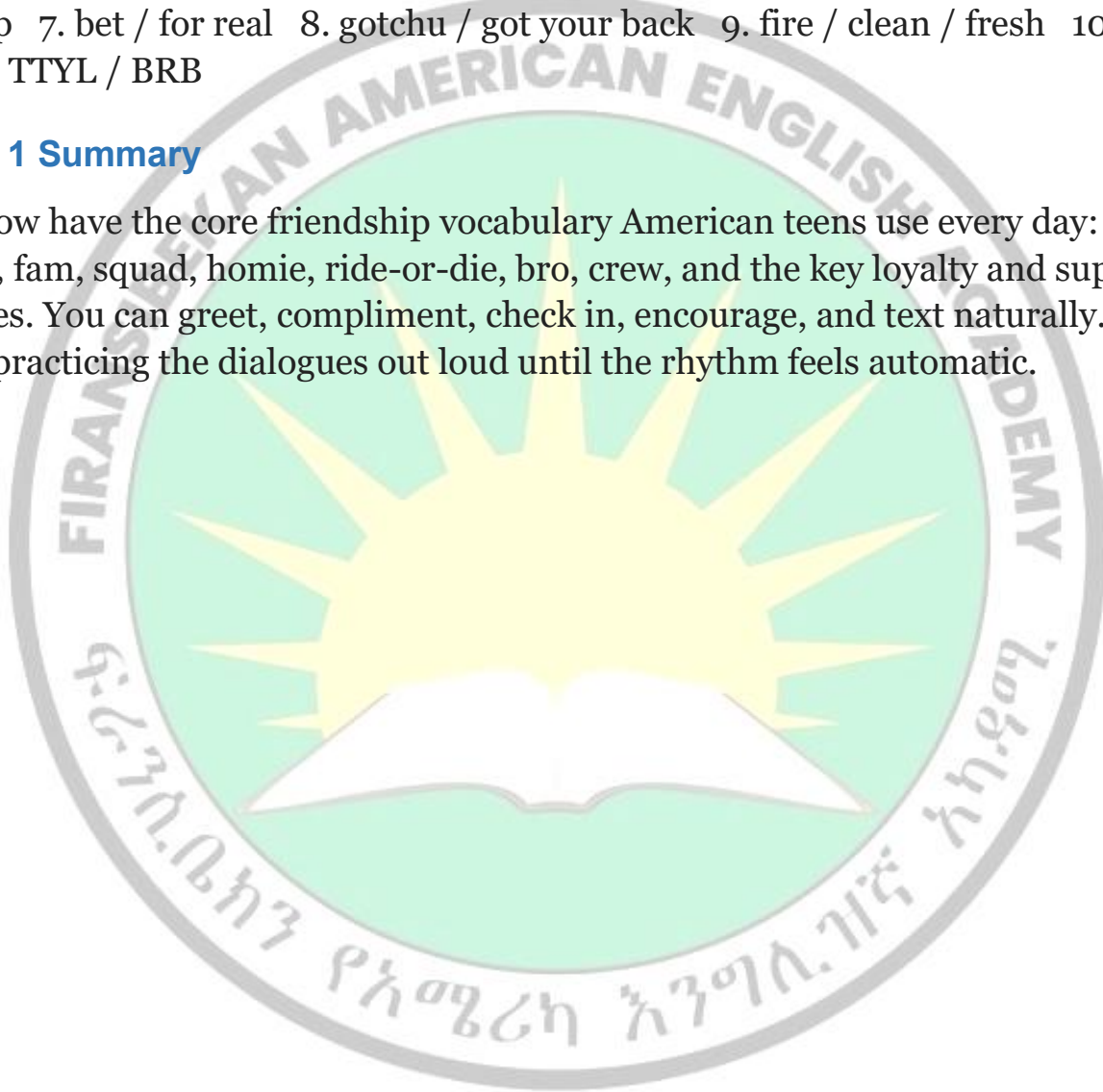
Write a 6-message text conversation between two best friends. Use at least five slang words or abbreviations from this chapter.

Answer Key – Exercise 1

1. up / good 2. best / GOAT (or best) 3. squad / crew 4. slay 5. ride 6. Facts / No cap 7. bet / for real 8. gotchu / got your back 9. fire / clean / fresh 10. G2G / TTYL / BRB

Topic 1 Summary

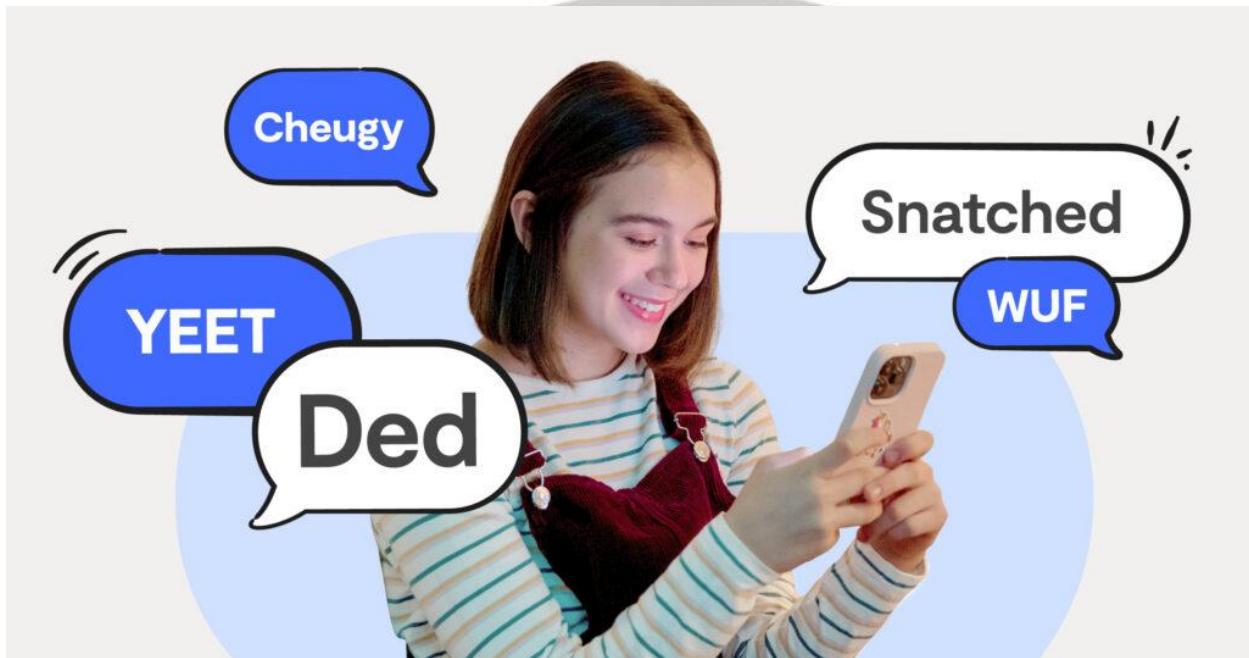
You now have the core friendship vocabulary American teens use every day: BFF, bestie, fam, squad, homie, ride-or-die, bro, crew, and the key loyalty and support phrases. You can greet, compliment, check in, encourage, and text naturally. Keep practicing the dialogues out loud until the rhythm feels automatic.



CHAPTER 2: YOUTH LIFE

Youth Life

Growing Up in America



Being a teenager in America is an adventure. Between school, friends, social media, part-time jobs, and family rules, there is always something happening. And of course, American teens have special slang words for almost every part of daily life.

In this topic you will learn how to talk about high school, teachers, weekend plans, social media, home life, jobs, crushes, and peer pressure.

In this chapter, we'll learn all the slang you need to:

- ✓ Talk about high school life
- ✓ Describe your teachers and classes
- ✓ Make weekend plans with friends
- ✓ Navigate social media like a pro
- ✓ Talk about home life and parents
- ✓ Discuss part time jobs and making money
- ✓ Talk about crushes and dating
- ✓ Handle peer pressure

Let's get into it!

Area 1 · Meaning

2.1 High School Words

Freshman

Meaning: A 9th grader – first year of high school. You're new and everything is exciting (and scary!).

Example: "I'm a freshman this year. I'm so nervous!"

Example: I'm a freshman, so everything still feels new.

Cultural Note: Being a freshman means you're at the bottom of the school hierarchy. Older students often tease freshmen. But don't worry – you'll move up!

Sophomore

Meaning: 10th grader – second year of high school. You're not new anymore, but you're not a senior either.

Example: I'm a sophomore now. I finally know my way around.

Junior

Meaning: 11th grader – third year. College prep starts getting serious.

Example: I'm a junior, so I'm stressing about college applications.

Senior

Meaning: A 12th grader final year. You're at the top or You're the boss of the school.

Example: I'm a senior! I can't wait to graduate.

Cultural Note: Seniors have special privileges, like senior parking spots, senior prom, and senior skip day. It's the best year!

The halls

Meaning: The school hallways where everyone, students hang out between classes. This is where you see friends, gossip, and make plans.

Example: I'll meet you in the halls after third period.

Lunch table

Meaning: The regular group of friends you sit with at lunch. The table where you and your friends sit during lunch. This is where you eat and talk about everything

Example: Save me a seat at our lunch table.

2.2 Teachers and Classes

Hard teacher / The hardest teacher

Meaning: A teacher who gives heavy homework, tough grades, and makes class difficult.

Example: Mr. Johnson is the hardest teacher in the whole school.

Easy A

Meaning: A teacher (or class) that gives good grades relatively easily.

Example: I hope I get Mrs. Davis for English. She's such an easy A.

Pop quiz

Meaning: A surprise test given without warning every student's nightmare.

Example: The teacher gave us a pop quiz today and I didn't study at all.

Group project

Meaning: An assignment done with classmates. Can be great or stressful depending on the group. A school project that you do with other students. Often stressful because not everyone does their share of the work.

Example: We have a group project due next week.

Example: "I hate group projects. I always end up doing all the work."

2.3 Weekend & Social Plans

Kick it

Meaning: Hang out casually. Relax and hang out with friends. Do nothing in particular.

Example: Let's kick it at the mall on Saturday.

Example: "Let's just kick it at my house this weekend."

Chill

Meaning: Relax, hang out in a low-key way. Relax; hang out; do nothing stressful.

Example: We just chilled at her house and watched movies.

Example: "We're just chilling at the park. Wanna come?"

Hang out

Meaning: Spend time together with friends casually.

Example: Wanna hang out after school?

Example: "I'm going to hang out with my crew after school."

Bounce

Meaning: Leave (quickly); head out.

Example: I gotta bounce. Curfew is in twenty minutes.

Example: "This party is boring. Let's bounce."

2.4 Social Media Life

Post

Meaning: Put a photo, video, or update online.

Example: I'm gonna post this picture on Instagram.

Scroll

Meaning: Look through your social media feed by moving your finger up and down.

Example: I spent all night scrolling through TikTok.

DM (Direct Message)

Meaning: Direct message a private message on social media.

Example: DM me the details so we can plan.

Example: "DM me the details so we can plan."

Pronunciation: "Dee em"

Like

Meaning: Click the "like" button on social media.

Example: "Did you like my photo? I need more likes!"

Follow

Meaning: Subscribe to someone's social media account so you see their posts.

Example: "I'm going to follow that influencer. Her content is so good."

Story

Meaning: A photo or video that disappears after 24 hours (Instagram, Snapchat, etc.).

Example: Did you see my story? I posted it this morning.

Streak

Meaning: A continuous daily exchange of snaps or messages on Snapchat. Snapchat streaks when you and a friend send snaps to each other every day for many days in a row.

Example: We've had a streak for 200 days.

Example: "We have a 100 day streak! I can't break it!"

2.5 Home Life

'Rents

Meaning: Parents (shortened, casual).

Example: My 'rents are trippin' about curfew.

Example: "My 'rents are making me clean my room."

Curfew

Meaning: The time you must be home by (set by your parents).

Example: My curfew is 10 on weeknights.

Example: "My curfew is 10 PM. I have to be home by then."

Grounded

Meaning: Punished by being restricted from going out or using privileges. Being punished by your parents – you can't go out or use your phone.

Example: I came home late, so I'm grounded for a week.

Example: "I'm grounded for a week because I came home late."

Chores

Meaning: Household tasks assigned by parents you have to do (like cleaning, dishes, laundry).

Example: I still must do my chores before I can leave.

Example: "I have to do my chores before I can hang out."

2.6 Jobs & Money

Hustle

Meaning: Work hard to make money can be a job or a side project.

Example: I'm always hustling. I work at the store and I do tutoring too.

Side gig

Meaning: A small job done for extra money in addition to school or a main job.

Example: I have a side gig walking dogs on the weekends.

Minimum Wage

Meaning: The lowest amount of money an employer can pay you (set by law).

Example: "I'm making minimum wage at my job. It's not much, but it's something."

Clock In / Clock Out

Meaning: Record when you start and finish work (using a time clock).

Example: "I clock in at 9 AM and clock out at 5 PM."

2.7 Teen Romance

Crush

Meaning: Someone you like romantically. You have feelings for them.

Example: I have a huge crush on Jake. He's so cute!"

Talking

Meaning: The early stage of getting to know someone romantically—before official dating. the "getting to know you" stage.

Example: Are you two talking? I see you text him a lot.

Ghost

Meaning: Suddenly stop all contact with someone without explanation. Suddenly stop responding to someone you were talking to. Disappear without explanation.

Example: He ghosted me after three weeks of texting.

Example: "We were talking for weeks, and then he just ghosted me."

Simp

Meaning: Someone who is overly attentive or submissive toward someone they like, often to an excessive degree. without getting anything back.

Example: Stop simping over her. Just be cool.

Example: "He bought her flowers and she didn't even say thank you. He's such a simp."

Smash

Meaning: To make out or be physically intimate (casual, not serious).

Example: "They've been smashing, but it's not serious."

Cultural Note: This is a casual term. It doesn't mean a serious relationship.

2.8 Peer Pressure & Mindset

FOMO (Fear Of Missing Out)

Meaning: Fear Of Missing Out – the anxious feeling that everyone else is having fun without you. The feeling that everyone is having fun without you.

Example: I hate staying home on Fridays. I get major FOMO.

YOLO (You Only Live Once)

Meaning: You Only Live Once – used to justify doing something fun, risky, or spontaneous. Used to justify doing something risky, fun, or crazy.

Example: Let's go skydiving. YOLO!

Cultural Note: Use this carefully. It's often used as a joke for doing something fun, but sometimes it's used to justify bad decisions.

Do it for the gram

Meaning: Do something mainly so you can post it on Instagram. Not always a good reason!

Example: He only jumped in the pool for the gram. So extra.

Fit In

Meaning: Try to be like everyone else so you're accepted.

Example: "I don't want to just fit in. I want to be myself."

Peer Pressure

Meaning: The influence from people in your age group to do things (good or bad).

Example: "I felt a lot of peer pressure to go to the party, but I stayed home and studied."

Area 2 · Informal Conversation

Talking About School

"That teacher is so extra." – Use when a teacher is being overly dramatic, giving too much work, or being unfair.

"I got a pop quiz today!" – Classic complaint about a surprise test.

Making Weekend Plans

"Let's kick it at the mall." → "Bet. I'm down."

Talking About Parents

"My 'rents are trippin' about curfew."

"I'm grounded for a week." → "Oof, that's rough, bro."

Talking About Dating

"Are you two talking?" – Soft way to ask if two people are in the early romantic stage.

Area 3 · Pronunciation – Connected Speech

Americans almost never say the full forms in casual speech:

Slang	Simple Meaning
going to	gonna
want to	wanna
got to / have got to	gotta
let me	lemme
I got your	I gotchu

2.9 PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

"Gonna" vs. "Going to"

Americans almost NEVER say "going to." They say "gonna."

Formal	Natural
"I am going to go to the mall."	"I'm gonna go to the mall."
"We are going to hang out later."	"We're gonna hang out later."

Practice saying these out loud:

- "I'm gonna chill this weekend."
- "We're gonna bounce after class."

"Wanna" vs. "Want to"

Americans say "wanna" instead of "want to."

Formal	Natural
"Do you want to go?"	"Wanna go?"
"I want to eat."	"I wanna eat."

Practice saying these out loud:

- "Wanna hang out later?"
- "I don't wanna do homework."

"Gotta" vs. "Got to"

Americans say "gotta" instead of "got to" or "have to."

Formal	Natural
"I have got to go now."	"I gotta go now."
"You have got to see this."	"You gotta see this."

Practice saying these out loud:

1. "I gotta go home. My curfew is at 10."
2. "You gotta see this new movie."

"Lemme" vs. "Let me"

Americans say "lemme" instead of "let me."

Formal	Natural
"Let me see."	"Lemme see."
"Let me know."	"Lemme know."

Practice saying these out loud:

1. "Lemme see your phone for a sec."
2. "Lemme know what time you're coming."

Connected Speech Practice

American English is all about CONNECTING words. Don't say each word separately. Let them flow together!

Bad: "I am going to go home."

Good: "I'm gonna go home."

Bad: "Do you want to come?"

Good: "Wanna come?"

Bad: "Let me see your phone."

Good: "Lemme see your phone."

Quick Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each. Focus on connecting the words!

1. "I'm gonna go to the mall with my squad."
2. "Wanna come to my party on Saturday?"
3. "I gotta go home now. My curfew is at 10."
4. "Lemme see your phone for a sec."

2.10 REAL LIFE CONVERSATIONS

Dialogue 1: First Day of School

Setting: Two freshmen meet on the first day.

Mia: "Hey! Are you a freshman too?"

Liam: "Yeah! I'm so nervous. I don't know where anything is."

Mia: "Same! This school is huge. I'm totally lost."

Liam: "What class do you have first?"

Mia: "I have English. What about you?"

Liam: "Me too! We can walk together."

Mia: "Bet. That's so helpful. I was freaking out."

Liam: "We got this. We can figure it out together."

Mia: "Good vibes only! Let's do this."

Dialogue 2: Talking About a Hard Teacher

Setting: Two juniors complaining about class.

Nate: "Bro, I can't with Mr. Thompson. He's the hardest teacher ever."

Olivia: "For real! He gave us a pop quiz today and I didn't study."

Nate: "Same! I literally guessed on half the questions."

Olivia: "I'm so stressed. I need an A in this class."

Nate: "We should study together. We can help each other."

Olivia: "That's actually a good idea. When are you free?"

Nate: "I'm free after school on Friday. Wanna hit the library?"

Olivia: "Bet. I'll be there. We got this."

Nate: "Good luck with the class. You'll do great."

Olivia: "Thanks. You too, bro."

Dialogue 3: Talking About Weekend Plans

Setting: Two friends texting.

Friend 1: "Yo, what are you doing this weekend?"

Friend 2: "Nothing much. Just chilling at home. You?"

Friend 1: "I'm gonna kick it with my squad on Saturday. Wanna come?"

Friend 2: "For real? Where are you going?"

Friend 1: "We're just gonna hang out at the park and grab some food."

Friend 2: "That sounds chill. What time?"

Friend 1: "Around 3. I'll DM you the details."

Friend 2: "Bet. I'm so down. I need to get out of the house."

Friend 1: "Same. My 'rents are driving me crazy."

Friend 2: "LOL. I feel you. See you Saturday!"

Dialogue 4: Talking About Home Life and Curfew

Setting: Kitchen at home. Serious conversation.

Mom: "Hey honey, can we talk for a minute?"

You: "Yeah, what's up?"

Mom: "I want to talk about your curfew. You came home at 11:30 last night. We agreed on 10 PM."

You: "I know, I'm so sorry. We lost track of time. The movie went longer than we thought."

Mom: "I understand, but rules are rules. You're grounded this weekend."

You: "Mom, no! Everyone's going to the movies this weekend. Please?"

Mom: "You should've thought about that before breaking curfew."

You: (sighs) "You're right. I'm sorry. I won't do it again."

Dialogue 5: Texting About a Party

Text Conversation:

Friend: "Yo! There's a party at Jake's house on Saturday night."

You: "For real? Is it gonna be lit?"

Friend: "Yeah, the whole school is coming. You gotta come!"

You: "IDK, my 'rents are so strict. They might not let me."

Friend: "FOMO, bro! Don't miss out. Everyone's gonna be there."

You: "Lemme ask and see what they say. I'll DM you later."

Friend: "Bet. I hope you can come!" (30 minutes later)

You: "Guess what? My parents said YES!"

Friend: "No way! That's fire!"

Dialogue 6: Social Media Scrolling

Setting: Two friends hanging out, scrolling on their phones.

Jenna: "OMG, did you see what Olivia posted on her story?"

Mia: "No, I haven't checked yet. Lemme see."

Jenna: "She's at the beach! I'm so jealous."

Mia: "Ugh, I literally just scrolled past it. She's always posting the best stuff."

Jenna: "I know. I'm just sitting here doing homework. So boring."

Mia: "Same. I've been scrolling for like an hour."

Jenna: "Did you see my new post? I posted a pic from last weekend."

Mia: "Yes! I liked it. You looked so cute!"

Jenna: "Thanks! I got so many likes."

Dialogue 7: Talking About School Stress

Setting: In the library, studying together.

Ethan: "Bro, I'm so stressed. Junior year is killing me."

Olivia: "Same! I have so much homework. I can't keep up."

Ethan: "And my parents keep talking about college. I don't even know what I want to do."

Olivia: "I feel you. Everyone's pressuring me about the future."

Ethan: "Like, let me breathe! I'm only 16."

Olivia: "Right? They need to chill out."

Ethan: "Wanna study together this weekend? We can help each other."

Olivia: "Bet. That would be so helpful."

Ethan: "You got this. We both got this."

Olivia: "Good vibes only. Let's do this!"

2.11 PRACTICE EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete these sentences with the right youth slang word:

- "I'm a _____ this year. It's my first year of high school."
- "The teacher gave us a surprise test today. It was a _____."
- "I'm so excited for the weekend. I'm just going to _____ with my friends."
- "My _____ won't let me stay out past 10 PM."
- "I'm trying to make some extra money. I have a _____ walking dogs."
- "She's my _____. I like her so much."
- "I can't stay home on Friday. I get major _____."
- "He just stopped texting me. He totally _____ me."
- "I _____ at 9 AM and _____ at 5 PM every day."
- "Let's go skydiving! _____!"

Exercise 2: Match the Slang to Its Meaning

Slang Word	Meaning
1. Freshman	a. 10th grader
2. Sophomore	b. 11th grader
3. Junior	c. 12th grader
4. Senior	d. 9th grader
5. Curfew	e. Parents
6. 'Rents	f. Time to be home by
7. Grounded	g. Being punished
8. DM	h. Private message
9. FOMO	i. Fear of missing out
10. YOLO	j. You only live once

Exercise 3: Translate to Teen Slang

Change these formal sentences into teen slang:

1. Formal: "I am going to go home now."
Slang: _____
2. Formal: "Do you want to go to the movies?"
Slang: _____
3. Formal: "I have to go. My parents are calling me."
Slang: _____
4. Formal: "Let me know what time you are coming."
Slang: _____
5. Formal: "Are you okay? You look sad."
Slang: _____

Exercise 4: Create Your Own Dialogue

Write a short dialogue between two friends about a stressful school situation. Use at least 8 slang words from this chapter.

- Friend 1: _____
- Friend 2: _____
- Friend 1: _____
- Friend 2: _____
- Friend 1: _____
- Friend 2: _____
- Friend 1: _____
- Friend 2: _____

Practice sentences:

6. I'm gonna chill this weekend.
7. Wanna hang out later?
8. I gotta bounce. My curfew is at 10.
9. Lemme know if you're coming.

Area 4 · Real-Life Speaking & Practice

Create short dialogues using new vocabulary: meeting in the halls, complaining about a hard teacher, making weekend plans, talking about a crush, or explaining why you are grounded.

Quick Practice – Fill in the Blanks

1. I'm a _____ this year, so college applications are stressing me out.
2. The teacher gave us a _____ and I hadn't studied.
3. Let's _____ at the mall after school.
4. My _____ said I have to be home by 9.
5. I have major _____ every time my friends go out without me.

Answers:

1. junior
2. pop quiz
3. kick it / hang out / chill
4. 'rents / parents
5. FOMO



CHAPTER 3: EMOTIONS SLANG

Expressing Your Feelings Like a Native



American teens are very expressive with their emotions! They use colorful slang to describe exactly how they're feeling. In this chapter, you'll learn how to express every emotion—from excitement to sadness, from anger to calmness.

How You Really Feel

Being a teenager is an emotional rollercoaster. One minute you are on top of the world; the next you are in your feels. American teens have colorful slang for almost every emotional state—far more precise than simple “happy” or “sad.”

Area 1 · Meaning

Happy & Excited

Lit

Meaning: Exciting, fun, excellent—especially about a party, event, or moment.

Example: *That party was lit.*

Example: "This party is so lit! I never want to leave!"

Usage: Use this when something is amazing. It can describe parties, music, or anything fun.

Fire

Meaning: Really good or cool. Similar to "lit."

Example: *This new song is fire.*

Example: "This new song is fire! I can't stop listening to it."

Usage: Similar to "lit" but often used for things like music, fashion, and food.

Stoked

Meaning: Very excited about something that is going to happen.

Example: "I'm so stoked for the concert! I've been waiting for months!"

Usage: Use this when you're excited about a future event.

Pumped

Meaning: Very Energized and excited.

Example: *I'm pumped for the game tonight.*

Usage: Similar to "stoked" but with more physical energy.

Vibing

Meaning: Feeling good, relaxed, enjoying the atmosphere, and in a positive flow.

Example: *I'm Just vibing with the music. It's so chill."*

Usage: Use this when you're really enjoying a moment.

On Cloud Nine

Meaning: Extremely happy. Like you're floating on a cloud!

Example: "I got an A on my test! I'm on cloud nine!"

Usage: Use this for extreme happiness.

Quick Reference: Happy Words

Word	Meaning	Example
Lit	Really good/exciting	"The party was lit!"
Fire	Really good/cool	"This song is fire!"
Stoked	Very excited	"I'm stoked for the concert!"
Pumped	Excited/energized	"I'm pumped for the game!"
Vibing	Enjoying the moment	"I'm just vibing."

Sad & Low(DOWN)

Bummed

Meaning: Disappointed or mildly sad.

Example: I'm bummed we can't go.

Example: "I'm so bummed I couldn't go to the party."

Usage: Use this for mild disappointment or sadness.

Down

Meaning: Feeling sad or low. Not your usual happy self.

Example: I've been feeling down today.

Example: "I don't know why, but I've been feeling down today."

Usage: Similar to "sad" but more casual.

In my feels

Meaning: Feeling emotional, often sad or nostalgic.

Example: That movie had me in my feels.

Example: "I watched a sad movie and now I'm in my feels."

Usage: Use this when you're feeling emotional.

Blue

Meaning: Sad or depressed (mildly). Feeling a little low.

Example: "I've been feeling blue since my dog passed away."

Usage: This is an older word that's still commonly used.

Angry & Frustrated

Salty

Meaning: Annoyed, bitter, or upset often about something relatively small.

Example: Why are you so salty just because I won?

Usage: Use this when someone is being petty or bitter.

Heated

Meaning: Very angry; upset. Angry or very intense in an argument.

Example: Things got heated during the debate.

Example: "I'm so heated right now! He lied to me!"

Usage: Use this for strong anger.

Fed up

Meaning: Completely tired of a situation; at the limit of patience. done with something.

Example: I'm fed up with all the drama.

Example: "I'm fed up with all this drama. I can't take it anymore."

Usage: Use this when you've had enough.

Extra

Meaning: Being dramatic or over the top.

Example: "You're being so extra. Calm down."

Usage: Use this when someone is being too dramatic.

Nervous, ANXIOUS & Scared

Shook

Meaning: Shocked, scared, disturbed, startled, or emotionally shaken.

Example: I'm still shook from that ending.

Example: "I'm shocked by what happened. I can't believe it."

Usage: Use this when something really affects you.

Butterflies

Meaning: Nervous excitement (often romantic or before a performance) A nervous feeling in your stomach.

Example: I get butterflies every time I see her.

Example: "I have butterflies in my stomach before the presentation."

Usage: Use this for nervous excitement.

Freaking out

Meaning: Panicking or extremely anxious. Very anxious or scared.

Example: I'm freaking out about the presentation.

Example: "I'm freaking out about the test tomorrow. I didn't study!"

Usage: Use this for extreme nervousness.

Embarrassed & Awkward

Cringe

Meaning: So embarrassing or awkward that it makes you uncomfortable.

Example: I fell in front of everyone. That was so cringe.

Usage: Use this for secondhand embarrassment or personal embarrassment.

Awkward

Meaning: Uncomfortable or embarrassing. Social situation.

Example: The silence after that joke was awkward.

Example: "That conversation was so awkward. I didn't know what to say."

Usage: Use this for uncomfortable situations.

Facepalm

Meaning: The gesture (or feeling) of covering your face in embarrassment or disbelief. Slapping your face with your hand (or wanting to). Used for something stupid or embarrassing.

Example: He said what? Facepalm.

Example: "He said that to the teacher? Facepalm."

Usage: Use this to show you can't believe something so stupid/embarrassing.

SURPRISED AND SHOCKED

No way

Meaning: I can't believe it! (I don't believe it!)

Example: You got tickets to the show? No way!

Usage: Use this when you're shocked or impressed.

For real

Meaning: Are you serious? / Is that true? Really?

Example: For real? You're moving?

Example: "You got accepted to Harvard? For real?"

Usage: Use this when you're surprised and want confirmation.

Dead

Meaning: Extremely shocked or amused (also used for "exhausted").

- So funny that you feel like you're dead (figuratively).

Example: I'm dead. I can't believe that happened.

Example: "That joke was so funny. I'm dead."

Usage: Use this for extreme laughter.

CALM, RELAXED & TIRED

Chill

Meaning: Relaxed, calm, not stressed or easygoing.

Example: I'm just chilling at home.

Example: "Just chill, bro. Everything will be fine."

Usage: Use this to tell someone to relax or to describe a calm situation.

Good vibes

Meaning: Positive energy or atmosphere.

Example: This place has good vibes.

Example: "I just want good vibes today. No drama."

Usage: Use this to express your desire for a positive environment.

Zen

Meaning: Completely calm, Peaceful and centered.

Example: After yoga I feel completely zen

Example: "I feel so zen after yoga. It's amazing."

Usage: Use this for extreme calmness.

Wiped

Meaning: Extremely tired; exhausted.

Example: After practice I'm wiped.

Example: "I had practice and then homework. I'm so wiped."

Usage: Use this for physical exhaustion.

Zonked

Meaning: Completely exhausted.

Example: I'm zonked. Going straight to bed.

Example: "I pulled an all-nighter. I'm totally zonked."

Usage: Similar to "wiped."

Burned out

Meaning: Exhausted from long-term stress or overwork.

Example: I'm burned out from all the studying.

Example: "I'm so burned out from studying. I need a break."

Usage: Use this for mental exhaustion.

Cool

Meaning: Calm and collected; okay.

Example: "I'm cool with that. Whatever you want."

Usage: Use this to show you're fine with something.

Dead

Meaning: Very tired.

Example: "I've been up since 5 AM. I'm dead."

Usage: Use this for extreme tiredness.

Emotions Slang

Living my best life

Meaning: Currently enjoying life fully and unapologetically.

Example: "At the beach with no responsibilities — living my best life."

Main character moment

Meaning: A moment where you feel like the star of your own story.

Example: "Walking in slow motion to that song — pure main character moment."

Going through it

Meaning: Currently dealing with a hard emotional period.

Example: "She's really going through it right now."

Not okay

Meaning: Struggling more seriously (honest admission).

Example: "I'm not okay, to be honest."

Big mad / Big sad

Meaning: Emphatic way to say very angry or very sad (internet style).

Example: "He was big mad about the call-out."

Over it

Meaning: Completely done with a situation.

Example: "I'm over it. I'm done."

I can't even

Meaning: So overwhelmed by emotion or absurdity that you can't respond properly.

Example: "The plot twist was so crazy I can't even."

Running on empty

Meaning: Continuing despite having almost no energy left.

Example: "I'm running on empty but I have to finish."

PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Saying "Lit" with Energy

Pronunciation: LIT (short, sharp vowel)

Practice:

- "This party is LIT!"
- "That concert was LIT!"

Say it with energy and enthusiasm!

Saying "Stoked" Correctly

Pronunciation: STOKED (long "O" sound)

Practice:

- "I'm so STOKED for the concert!"
- "I'm STOKED about the trip!"

Emphasize the long "O" sound.

Saying "Bummed" with Sadness

Pronunciation: BUHMD (short "U" sound)

Practice:

- "I'm so BUMMED..."
- "That's so BUMMING."

Say it with a lower tone to show sadness.

Saying "Heated" with Anger

Pronunciation: HEE ted (strong "H")

Practice:

- "I'm so HEATED right now!"
- "She was HEATED about it."

Say it with a sharp, aggressive tone.

Practicing the "Th" Sound

For "shook" and "them," practice the "th" sound (tongue between teeth):

"Shook":

- "I'm SHOOK by what happened."
- "That movie SHOOK me."

"Them":

- "I can't deal with THEM right now."
- "Tell THEM I said hi."

Quick Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each. Focus on the feeling in your voice!

Excitement (LOUD + HIGH):

1. "This party is LIT!"
2. "I'm so STOKED for the concert!"
3. "Your outfit is FIRE!"

Sadness (LOW + SLOW):

4. "I'm so BUMMED..."
5. "I've been feeling DOWN today..."
6. "I'm kind of in my FEELS..."

Anger (SHARP + FAST):

7. "Why are you so SALTY?"
8. "I'm so HEATED right now!"
9. "I'm fed up with this!"

REAL LIFE CONVERSATIONS

Dialogue 1: Sharing Exciting News

Setting: At school, between classes.

Aisha: "OMG! You won't believe what happened!"

Maya: "What?? Tell me right now!"

Aisha: "I got accepted into the summer art program at the university!"

Maya: "NO WAY! For real?!"

Aisha: "No cap! I'm so stoked! I've been waiting for this forever!"

Maya: "That's fire! I'm so happy for you!"

Aisha: "Thanks! I'm literally on cloud nine right now."

Maya: "You deserve this so much. You're so talented."

Aisha: "Stop, you're gonna make me cry. I'm in my feels."

Maya: "Happy feels only! This calls for a celebration!"

Aisha: "Let's get some grub after school to celebrate!"

Maya: "Bet! I'm so pumped for you!"

Dialogue 2: Arguing (But Making Up)

Setting: Two friends after a misunderstanding.

Ella: "I'm so heated right now! How could you forget my birthday?"

Nate: "I know, I'm an idiot. I feel terrible. I'm so sorry."

Ella: "I told you about it like five times! You're so extra sometimes."

Nate: "You're right. I messed up. I was stressed with school and I completely forgot."

Ella: "I just felt so bummed. I was really looking forward to hanging out."

Nate: "I know, and I ruined it. I'll make it up to you. I promise."

Ella: (softening) "Okay... I'm not mad anymore. Just a little salty."

Nate: "I'll take salty. That's better than heated."

Ella: (laughing) "You're so stupid. I can't stay mad at you."

Nate: "You know I love you. You're my bestie."

Ella: "Alright, alright. You're forgiven. But you're paying for lunch."

Nate: "Deal! Whatever you want."

Dialogue 3: Reacting to a Surprise

Setting: Two friends at a coffee shop.

Ryan: "So... I have news."

Mia: "What kind of news? Good news? Bad news?"

Ryan: "Good news! I got accepted into my dream college!"

Mia: "NO WAY! For real?!"

Ryan: "For real! I just got the email this morning!"

Mia: "I can't even! That's amazing! I'm so stoked for you!"

Ryan: "Thanks! I'm still in shock. I thought I wouldn't get in."

Mia: "Are you kidding? You're so smart! You deserved it!"

Ryan: "I'm literally on cloud nine right now."

Mia: "I'm dead! This is so exciting! We have to celebrate!"

Ryan: "For real. I'm still processing it. I'm shook."

Mia: "Drinks are on me today!"

Dialogue 4: Cheering Up a Sad Friend

Setting: Two friends in the park.

Sarah: "What's wrong? You've been so quiet."

Emma: "I don't know. I've just been feeling down lately."

Sarah: "Like, in your feels?"

Emma: "Yeah. I'm just so stressed about everything."

Sarah: "I feel you. School can be so overwhelming."

Emma: "And my parents keep fighting. It's just a lot."

Sarah: "I'm so sorry. That sounds really hard."

Emma: "I'm so bummed. I don't know what to do."

Sarah: "You can always talk to me. I'm here for you."

Emma: "Thanks. You're the best."

Sarah: "You got this, girl. I believe in you."

Emma: (smiling slightly) "Good vibes only, right?"

Sarah: "Exactly. Now let's get some ice cream. That'll cheer you up!"

Emma: "That sounds amazing. You always know what to do."

Dialogue 5: Feeling Embarrassed

Setting: At school, after an embarrassing incident.

Jake: "Bro, did you see what happened in class?"

Marcus: "You mean when you tripped in front of everyone?"

Jake: "Don't remind me. That was so cringe."

Marcus: "It was pretty awkward. I won't lie."

Jake: "Everyone saw me fall. I wanted to disappear."

Marcus: "It happens to everyone, man. Don't stress."

Jake: "I'm so embarrassed. I can't even face people."

Marcus: "Chill out. It wasn't that bad. People will forget."

Jake: "I don't know. It felt like a disaster."

Marcus: "You're trippin'. It's all good. Just laugh it off."

Jake: "I guess. I'm just in my feels about it."

Marcus: "For real, don't worry. I fell in class last year too."

Jake: "Wait, really?"

Marcus: "Yeah! I was so cringe. But I got over it."

Jake: "That makes me feel better. Thanks, bro."

Marcus: "That's what homies are for."

PRACTICE EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete these sentences with the right emotion slang word:

1. "This party is so _____! I never want to leave!"
2. "I'm so _____ for the concert! I can't wait!"
3. "I watched a sad movie and now I'm in my _____."
4. "Why are you so _____ just because I won the game?"
5. "He lied to me! I'm so _____ right now!"
6. "I have _____ in my stomach before the presentation."
7. "I fell down in front of everyone. That was so _____."
8. "You got tickets to the show? _____!"
9. "I'm just _____ at home today. No stress."
10. "I've been up since 5 AM. I'm _____."

Exercise 2: Match the Emotion to the Slang

Emotion	Slang
1. Excited	a. Salty
2. Angry	b. Cringe
3. Sad	c. Lit
4. Embarrassed	d. Bummed
5. Surprised	e. Stoked
6. Relaxed	f. Chill
7. Tired	g. Heated
8. Happy	h. No Way
9. Awkward	i. Facepalm
10. Frustrated	j. Wiped

Exercise 3: Create Your Own Conversations

Write a short dialogue for each situation. Use emotion slang words!

Situation 1: Your friend just told you exciting news.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 2: Your friend is feeling sad and you cheer them up.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 3: Something awkward happened at school.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Area 2–4 · Using Emotion Slang

“I’m so stoked!” – pure excitement.

“I’m kind of in my feels.” – soft way to say you’re emotional.

“Why are you so salty?” – calling out unnecessary bitterness.

“I’m shook.” – genuine shock.

“That was so cringe.” – second-hand embarrassment.

Practice full short dialogues: one friend is stressed about a test, another is excited about a concert, a third is tired after a long week. Use at least three emotion terms in each exchange.

Chapter 3 Summary

You can now name a wide range of emotional states the way American teens do: lit, fire, stoked, in my feels, salty, shook, cringe, wiped, and more. Pair the words with the right tone and you will sound natural and empathetic.

Chapter 4 · Entertainment

Movies, Music, Gaming, Streaming & Parties



Entertainment is where a huge amount of teen slang lives. From the latest drop to a sold-out show to an all-night binge, these words help you talk about what you watch, listen to, play, and experience.

What do American teens do in their free time? They watch movies, listen to music, play video games, binge watch TV shows, and go to parties! And of course, they have special slang words for ALL of it.

In this chapter, we'll learn all the slang you need to:

- ✓ Talk about movies like a film critic
- ✓ Describe music and share your playlist
- ✓ Sound like a pro gamer
- ✓ Talk about binge watching shows
- ✓ Discuss concerts and live events
- ✓ Use YouTube and social media slang
- ✓ Describe parties and events
- ✓ Talk about books (without sounding boring!)

Let's get entertained!

Area 1 · Meaning by Category

Movies Slang

Spoiler

Meaning: Information that reveals key plot points and ruins the surprise or Someone who tells you the ending of a movie before you've seen it. The WORST!

Example: No spoilers! I haven't seen it yet.

Example: "Don't tell me what happens! No spoilers!"

Usage: Always say this before discussing a movie with someone who hasn't seen it yet.

Cliffhanger

Meaning: An ending that leaves you wanting more. You have to wait to find out what happens!

Example: "That movie ended on such a cliffhanger! I need the sequel!"

Flop

Meaning: A movie (or project) that fails commercially or critically or A movie that fails and makes no money. A total disaster.

Example: Everyone said it would be huge, but it was a flop.

Example: "That new superhero movie was a total flop. Nobody liked it."

Blockbuster

Meaning: A hugely successful movie. A very successful, popular movie that makes a lot of money.

Example: That sequel was a total blockbuster.

Example: "Avengers was a blockbuster. Everyone went to see it."

Must See

Meaning: A movie you absolutely have to watch.

Example: "I heard this movie is a must see. Let's go tonight!"

Bomb

Meaning: A movie that fails completely (similar to flop).

Example: "That movie bombed at the box office. It was terrible."

Music Slang

Banger

Meaning: A really good, energetic song especially one that makes you want to move.

Example: This track is a banger.

Example: "This song is such a banger! Turn it up!"

Vibe

Meaning: The feeling or atmosphere of a song (or place/person).

Example: I love the vibe of this album.

Example: "This song has such a good vibe. It makes me happy."

Hit

Meaning: A commercially successful song or A very popular song.

Example: Her new single is a hit.

Example: "That's a huge hit right now. Everyone's playing it."

Drop

Meaning: The release of a new song, album, or product; also, the climactic moment in a track.

Example: "When is the new album going to drop?"

Example: The new album drops on Friday.

Beat

Meaning: The rhythm/instrumental part of a song.

Example: "I love the beat in this song. It's so catchy."

Oldie

Meaning: An old, classic song.

Example: "I love listening to oldies from the 90s."

Playlist

Meaning: A list of songs you've collected to listen to.

Example: "Check out my playlist. I've got so many bangers on it."

Gaming Lingo

Noob

Meaning: A beginner or inexperienced player (can be teasing or insulting depending on tone) or A beginner or someone who isn't good at a game. (Sometimes used to tease!)

Example: Don't be a noob learn the controls.

Example: "You don't know how to play? You're such a noob!"

Pro

Meaning: A skilled, professional-level player or A professional; someone who is really, really good at a game.

Example: She's a pro at this game.

Example: "He's a pro at this game. He never loses."

Lag

Meaning: Delay between your action and what happens on screen, usually due to connection or when the game is slow or glitchy because of a bad internet connection.

Example: I died because of lag.

Example: "I can't play right now. The lag is so bad."

AFK (Away from Keyboard)

Meaning: Away From Keyboard – not at the computer/console right now or not playing because you're away from your computer/device.

Example: Sorry, I was AFK.

Example: "I'll be AFK for a minute. I need to get some water."

GG (Good Game)

Meaning: Good Game said at the end of a match, often as good sportsmanship.

Example: GG well played.

Example: "GG, everyone! That was fun!"

EZ (Easy)

Meaning: Easy – sometimes used to boast after a win (can annoy other players) or That was easy! (Often used to tease opponents.)

Example: That round was EZ.

Example: "That was EZ! You guys didn't even try!"

Pwned

Meaning: Defeated or dominated or completely defeated (from a misspelling of "owned").

Example: We got pwned in that match.

Example: "You got pwned! I destroyed you!"

Nerf

Meaning: To weaken something in a game (like a character or weapon).

Example: "They nerfed my favorite character! He's so weak now."

Binge WATCHING & Streaming

Binge

Meaning: Watch many episodes or a whole season in a short time or watch many episodes of a show in one sitting.

Example: I binged the entire series in two days.

Example: "I binged the whole season in one day!"

Marathon

Meaning: A long continuous session of watching or playing or watching many episodes or movies in a row.

Example: We did a horror movie marathon last night.

Example: "We had a Harry Potter marathon on Saturday."

Spoiler

Meaning: Revealing what happens (same as movies).

Example: "No spoilers! I haven't finished the show yet!"

Concerts, Events & Parties

Sold out

Meaning: No tickets left All tickets have been sold; you can't get in.

Example: The show sold out in ten minutes.

Example: "I couldn't get tickets. The concert was sold out."

The Pit

Meaning: The standing area closest to the stage (often more intense). The area in front of the stage is at a concert where people stand and dance.

Example: We were in the pit the whole time.

Example: "The pit was crazy! Everyone was jumping."

Headliner

Meaning: The main act at a concert or festival. The main performer at a concert.

Example: She's the headliner on Saturday.

Example: "The headliner was amazing. Best concert ever."

Turnt

Meaning: Very excited, energetic, or under the influence of the party atmosphere; hyped up.

Example: The whole party was turnt.

Bash / Rager

Meaning: A big, lively party.

Example: Their house party was a total rager.

Mosh Pit

Meaning: A chaotic area where people jump and push each other at a concert.

Example: "I stayed out of the mosh pit. I didn't want to get hurt."

PARTIES AND EVENTS

Lit

Meaning: A really fun party.

Example: "That party was so lit! Everyone was dancing."

Turnt

Meaning: Crazy, wild, and fun (party).

Example: "The party was so turnt! I can't believe what happened."

Bash

Meaning: A party.

Example: "She's throwing a bash for her birthday."

House Party

Meaning: A party at someone's house.

Example: "We're having a house party on Saturday."

Rager

Meaning: A wild, crazy party.

Example: "That was such a rager! I'm exhausted."

YouTube, SOCIAL MEDIA & Content

Sub (Subscribe)

Meaning: Subscribe (to a channel). Subscribe to a YouTube channel.

Example: "I subbed to his channel. His videos are so funny."

Example: Don't forget to sub.

Vlog

Meaning: Video blog – a personal video diary or lifestyle video.

Example: I posted a new vlog about my week.

Example: "She's a vlogger. She films her daily life and posts it."

Reaction

Meaning: A video reacting to another video, song, or trailer. A video showing someone reacting to something.

Example: "I love watching reaction videos. They're so entertaining."

Example: Have you seen her reaction to the trailer?

Like

Meaning: Click the like button on a video.

Example: "Don't forget to like and subscribe!"

Comment

Meaning: Write a comment on a video.

Example: "I commented on her video. She replied to me!"

Unboxing

Meaning: A video where someone opens a new product.

Example: "I watched an unboxing video for the new iPhone."

BOOKS AND READING

Page Turner

Meaning: A book that's so exciting you can't stop reading.

Example: "This book is a total page turner! I read it in one day."

Cliffhanger

Meaning: An exciting ending that makes you want to read the next book.

Example: "The book ended on a cliffhanger. I need the sequel!"

Series

Meaning: A set of books about the same characters.

Example: "I'm reading the Harry Potter series."

Music additions

Slaps

Meaning: Sounds really good (especially bass or overall quality).

Example: "This track slaps."

Earworm

Meaning: Song that stays stuck in your head.

Example: "That chorus is such an earworm."

Underground

Meaning: Not mainstream; known mainly in smaller scenes.

Example: "He's still underground but the quality is crazy."

Gaming Additions

Clutch

Meaning: Win a difficult situation against the odds.

Example: "That was a clutch play."

Rage quit

Meaning: Quit in anger after losing or frustration.

Example: "He rage-quit after the second round."

Camp / Camper

Meaning: Stay in one spot waiting to ambush (often criticized).

Example: "Stop camping."

Try-hard

Meaning: Someone who tries extremely hard (can be slightly negative).

Example: "He's such a try-hard in ranked."

Parties & live events

Pull up

Meaning: Show up / arrive (especially to a party or location).

Example: "Pull up around 10."

Afterparty

Meaning: Party that happens after the main event.

Example: "We're going to the afterparty."

Opener / Opening act

Meaning: Performer who plays before the headliner.

Example: "The opener was actually better."

Online / content culture

Thumbnail

Meaning: Preview image of a video (often exaggerated for clicks).

Example: "That thumbnail is so clickbait."

Going viral

Meaning: Spreading rapidly online.

Example: "That clip is going viral."

Clickbait

Meaning: Content designed mainly to attract clicks, often misleading.

Example: "Pure clickbait title."

PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Saying "Banger"

Pronunciation: BANG er (strong "A")

Practice:

- "This song is a BANGER!"

Saying "Flop"

Pronunciation: FLOP (short, sharp vowel)

Practice:

- "That movie was a total FLOP."

Saying "Noob"

Pronunciation: NOOB (long "OO" sound)

Practice:

- "You're such a NOOB at this game."

Saying "GG"

Pronunciation: GEE GEE

Practice: "GG, everyone! That was fun!"

Saying "AFK"

Pronunciation: AY FF KAY

Practice:

- "I'll be AFK for a minute."

Saying "Lit"

Pronunciation: LIT (short, sharp vowel)

Practice:

- "That party was so LIT!"

Conversation, Pronunciation & Practice

Use the terms in natural sentences: “That song is a banger.” “No spoilers!” “GG.” “We binged the whole season.” “The show was completely sold out.” “I’m still turnt from last night.”

Pronunciation tip: Keep gaming and music terms short and punchy. “Banger,” “lit,” “GG,” and “AFK” are clipped and energetic.

Practice

1. Describe a movie you loved or hated using “blockbuster,” “flop,” or “spoiler.”
2. Recommend a song and call it a “banger” or talk about its “vibe.”
3. Role-play the end of a game using “GG,” “EZ,” or “we got pwned.”

Quick Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each!

1. "This song is such a BANGER!"
2. "That movie was a total FLOP."
3. "You're such a NOOB at this game."
4. "GG, everyone! That was fun!"
5. "I'll be AFK for a minute."
6. "That party was so LIT!"
7. "I binged the whole season in one day!"
8. "Don't spoil it! I haven't seen it yet."

Pronunciation Tip: Stressing the Right Words

When you talk about entertainment, stress the important words:

Bad: "That MOVIE was a TOTAL FLOP." (Too much stress)

Good: "That movie was a TOTAL FLOP." (Stress "total flop")

REAL LIFE CONVERSATIONS

Dialogue 1: Movie Review with Friends

Setting: Walking out of the theater.

Tara: "So... what did you think of the movie?"

Kevin: "Honestly? It was a total flop."

Tara: "Facts! The ending was so predictable. I saw it coming from a mile away."

Kevin: "And they showed all the good parts in the trailer! That's such a spoiler."

Tara: "Ugh, I hate when they do that. There was no suspense."

Kevin: "Not a blockbuster, that's for sure."

Tara: "The acting was so cringe too."

Kevin: "I was so disappointed. I had high expectations."

Tara: "Same. I was expecting something amazing."

Kevin: "At least we got to hang out."

Tara: "True. That's the best part."

Kevin: "Next time, I'm picking the movie."

Tara: "Bet. You got this."

Dialogue 2: Online Gaming Chat

Setting: Fortnite or similar multiplayer game.

Player 1: "You guys ready? Let's do this!"

Player 2: "Yeah, let's go. No lag tonight, please."

Player 1: "I'm gonna dominate. Watch me."

Player 2: "You're such a noob. I'll carry you."

Player 1: "Ha! We'll see about that."

(During the game)

Player 2: "Nice shot! You pwned that guy!"

Player 1: "I know right? I'm a pro."

Player 2: "Don't get too cocky. There's more coming."

(After the game they won!)

Player 2: "GG! We won! That was so fun!"

Player 1: "EZ game. I told you I'm a pro."

Player 2: "Okay, okay. You were good today."

Player 1: "Good game, everyone. GG!"

Player 2: "Same time tomorrow?"

Player 1: "Bet. I'll be on at 8. Don't be AFK!"

Player 2: "I won't. See you then!"

Dialogue 3: After a Concert

Setting: Leaving the concert venue.

Chris: "Dude, that was INSANE!"

Sam: "I know! I can't even. My ears are ringing!"

Chris: "The pit was crazy! I almost lost my phone in the mosh pit."

Sam: "I stayed in the seats. I didn't want to get crushed."

Chris: "The headliner was SO good. Best concert ever."

Sam: "It was sold out too. We got so lucky with tickets."

Chris: "I know! I can't believe we got in."

Sam: "I'm still pumped. I can't sleep now."

Chris: "Same. I'm too excited. That was so lit!"

Sam: "I'm definitely going to their next concert."

Chris: "For sure. Let's get tickets early next time."

Sam: "Bet. We're so doing this again."

Dialogue 4: Talking About a Party

Setting: At school, Monday morning.

Jake: "Yo, did you go to the party on Saturday?"

Mia: "Yeah! It was so turnt! Everyone was there."

Jake: "I was so bummed I missed it. My 'rents made me stay home."

Mia: "Bro, you missed out! The whole squad was there."

Jake: "No cap? I heard it was lit."

Mia: "It was! People were dancing, the music was fire. It was a total rager."

Jake: "I'm so sad. FOMO is real."

Mia: "There's another bash next weekend at Kyle's house. You should come!"

Jake: "Bet! I'll definitely be there. Nothing's stopping me this time."

Mia: "Good! It's gonna be even better."

Jake: "I'm so stoked. Can't wait!"

Mia: "It'll be lit for sure!"

Dialogue 5: Sharing Music

Setting: Two friends listening to music.

Alex: "Hey, listen to this song. I just found it."

Jordan: "Okay, play it." (After listening)

Jordan: "Whoa! This is a total banger!"

Alex: "Right?! I've been listening to it on repeat."

Jordan: "The beat is so good. And the vibe is amazing."

Alex: "I know! It's a hit for sure."

Jordan: "You should add this to our playlist."

Alex: "Already did. It's been on my playlist all week."

Jordan: "When did it drop?"

Alex: "It dropped last Friday. It's been blowing up."

Jordan: "I'm so adding this to my favorites."

Dialogue 6: Binge Watching

Setting: Two friends on the phone.

Emma: "What are you doing right now?"

Liam: "Nothing. Just chilling at home."

Emma: "Did you start that new show everyone's talking about?"

Liam: "I binged the whole season yesterday!"

Emma: "No way! All in one day?"

Liam: "Yeah! It's so good. I couldn't stop watching."

Emma: "I've been meaning to watch it. Is it really that good?"

Liam: "It's amazing! Total cliffhanger at the end."

Emma: "Don't spoil it! I haven't seen it yet."

Liam: "I won't! But you have to watch it."

Emma: "I'm gonna start it tonight."

Liam: "You're gonna love it. It's a real page turner!"

PRACTICE EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete these sentences with the right entertainment slang word:

1. "Don't tell me the ending! No _____!"
2. "That new movie was a total _____. Nobody liked it."
3. "Turn up the volume! This song is such a _____!"
4. "You don't know how to play this game? You're such a _____!"
5. "That was a good game. _____!"
6. "I stayed up all night and _____ the whole season."
7. "I couldn't get tickets. The concert was _____."
8. "The _____ was crazy! People were jumping everywhere."
9. "I _____ to his YouTube channel. His videos are so funny."
10. "That party was so _____. Everyone was dancing!"

Exercise 2: Match the Slang to Its Meaning

Slang Word	Meaning
1. Spoiler	a. A really good song
2. Blockbuster	b. A beginner who isn't good
3. Banger	c. Someone who tells the ending
4. Noob	d. A huge successful movie
5. GG	e. Away from keyboard
6. AFK	f. A super fun party
7. Lit	g. A video about daily life
8. Pit	h. The area in front of the stage
9. Vlog	i. Good game
10. Turnt	j. Amazing/crazy (party)

Exercise 3: Choose the Right Slang

Read each situation and choose the best slang word:

Situation 1: You just watched an amazing movie.

You say: "That was a _____! Everyone should see it!"

- a) Flop
- b) Blockbuster
- c) Spoiler

Situation 2: You're playing a game and your friend is losing badly.

You say: "Ha! I completely _____ you!"

- a) Nerfed
- b) Pwned
- c) AFK

Situation 3: You're listening to a great song.

You say: "This is such a _____! I love it!"

- a) Flop
- b) Banger
- c) Spoiler

Situation 4: A concert is completely sold out.

You say: "We can't go. It's totally _____!"

- a) Sold out
- b) Lit
- c) Turnt

Situation 5: You're watching many episodes of a show.

You say: "I'm going to _____ this whole show!"

- a) AFK
- b) Flop
- c) Binge

Exercise 4: Translate to Teen Slang

Change these formal sentences into teen slang:

1. Formal: "That movie was very unsuccessful."
Slang: _____
2. Formal: "This song is very good."
Slang: _____
3. Formal: "I am going to watch many episodes of this show."
Slang: _____
4. Formal: "We are having a big party on Saturday."
Slang: _____
5. Formal: "I am going to subscribe to that YouTube channel."
Slang: _____

Exercise 5: Create Your Own Conversations

Write a short dialogue for each situation. Use entertainment slang!

Situation 1: Talking about a movie you just watched.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 2: Playing a video game together.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 3: Talking about a party you went to.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Exercise 6: Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each with the right stress!

1. "This SONG is a BANGER!"
2. "That MOVIE was a total FLOP."
3. "You're such a NOOB at this GAME!"
4. "GG, everyone! That was FUN!"
5. "I'll be AFK for a MINUTE."
6. "That PARTY was so LIT!"
7. "I BINGED the WHOLE SEASON!"
8. "It was SOLD OUT in an HOUR!"
9. "The PIT was CRAZY!"
10. "I SUBBED to his CHANNEL!"

Chapter 5 · Lifestyle

Food, Fashion, Fitness, Money, Travel & Dreams

SLANG FOR LIFESTYLE

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Vibe: A person's emotional state or atmosphere.

Flex: Showcasing one's wealth or accomplishments.

Wave: The current trend or movement.

Mood: A relatable feeling or situation.

Grind: The daily hustle or routine.

Swag: Personal style or confidence.

Hustle: Working hard or chasing goals.

Groove: A personal rhythm or routine.

Flava: Unique style or essence.

Steez: A combination of style and ease.



Lifestyle slang covers the everyday choices that shape how teens present themselves and talk about their goals. These words appear constantly in conversation, captions, and group chats.

Life isn't just about school and friends – it's also about the things you do every day! How you eat, dress, exercise, and handle money says a lot about who you are. American teens have a whole vocabulary for their daily lives. In this chapter, you'll learn how to talk about:

- ✓ Food and eating
- ✓ Fashion and style
- ✓ Fitness and working out
- ✓ Money and earning
- ✓ Travel and trips
- ✓ Daily routines
- ✓ Goals and dreams

Let's get into it!

Area 1 · Meaning by Category

Food Slang

Grub

Meaning: Food (casual, everyday word).

Example: "I'm so hungry! Let's get some grub."

Example: *Let's get some grub.*

Usage: This is one of the most common food slang words.

Munchies

Meaning: Desire to eat, often snacky or late-night hunger.

- Hunger or craving for snacks.

Example: "I have the munchies. I need some chips."

Example: *I've got the munchies.*

Usage: Use this when you're craving snacks.

Snack

Meaning: A small amount of food; also, sometimes used to describe an attractive person.

- A small amount of food you eat between meals. (Also used to describe someone attractive!)

Example: "I just had a snack. I feel better now."

Example: *I need a snack before practice.*

Cultural Note: Calling someone a "snack" means they're attractive!

Bite

Meaning: A small meal; also means "a quick food(meal).

Example: *Wanna grab a bite after school?"?*

Treat

Meaning: Something special you eat (like dessert) or indulgent you give yourself.

Example: *I'm getting ice cream as a treat.*

Example: "I bought myself a treat. I deserve it."

Yummy

Meaning: Delicious.

Example: "This pizza is so yummy!"

Comfort Food

Meaning: Food that makes you feel good (often nostalgic).

Example: "Mac and cheese is my comfort food."

Eating Out

Takeout / To-go

Meaning: Food ordered and taken home.

- Food you order from a restaurant and take home.

Example: "I don't feel like cooking. Let's get takeout."

Example: *I'm just getting takeout tonight.*

Dine in

Meaning: Eat at the restaurant.

- Eating at the restaurant instead of taking it home.

Example: "We can dine in or get takeout. I don't care."

Example: *You want to dine in or get it to go?*

Drive-thru

Meaning: Service window you drive up to.

- Ordering food from your car at a fast-food restaurant.

Example: "Let's just go through the drive thru. I'm too tired to get out."

Example: *Let's hit the drive-thru.*

Grab a Bite

Meaning: Go out to eat something quickly.

Example: "Wanna grab a bite after school?"

Menu

Meaning: The list of food options at a restaurant.

Example: "Let me look at the menu and decide."

Order

Meaning: The food you request at a restaurant.

Example: "I'm going to order a burger and fries."

Fashion Slang

Drip

Meaning: Stylish clothing and overall fashion sense; looking very good.

- Stylish, cool clothing. You look really good!

Example: *Your drip is crazy today.*

Example: "Your outfit is so fire! You got drip!"

Usage: Use this to compliment someone's style.

Fit

Meaning: Outfit.

- : Outfit (short for "outfit"). What you're wearing.

Example: "I love your fit! Where did you get those shoes?"

Example: *That fit is fire.*

Fresh

Meaning: Clean, new-looking, stylish.

- : New and stylish. Looking really good.

Example: "You look so fresh today! New haircut?"

Example: *New shoes? Lookin' fresh.*

Clean

Meaning: Simple, sharp, well put-together style.

- Neat, stylish, and put together.

Example: "Your style is so clean. I love it."

Example: *His whole look is clean.*

Swag

Meaning: Confident personal style and presence.

- : Style, confidence, and coolness.

Example: "He's got so much swag. He always looks good."

Example: *She's got swag.*

Fly

Meaning: Stylish and attractive.

- Cool, stylish, good looking.

Example: "Those sneakers are fly! Where did you get them?"

Example: *You look fly in that jacket.*

Threads

Meaning: Clothes.

Example: "I need to buy some new threads for the party."

Fitness Slang

Gym rat

Meaning: Someone who spends a lot of time at the gym.

- Someone who goes to the gym a lot. They love working out!

Example: "He's such a gym rat. He's there every single day."

Example: *He's a total gym rat.*

Pump

Meaning: The temporary muscle fullness after lifting; also, the act of lifting.

- : The feeling of muscles getting big from working out.

Example: "I got a good pump today. My arms feel huge!"

Example: *I'm going for a pump.*

Gains

Meaning: Muscle growth or fitness progress.

- : Muscle growth and improvement. Getting bigger and stronger!

Example: "I'm seeing gains. My muscles are growing!"

Example: *I've been seeing real gains.*

Bulk

Meaning: Eating and training to gain muscle mass.

- To gain weight/muscle mass.

Example: "I'm bulking right now. I'm eating a lot of protein."

Example: *I'm on a bulk right now.*

Cut

Meaning: Eating and training to lose fat while keeping muscle.

- To lose fat while keeping muscle.

Example: "I'm going to cut after the holidays. I need to get lean."

Example: *I'm starting a cut next month.*

Workout

Meaning: Exercise session.

Example: "I had a great workout today. I feel amazing."

Cardio

Meaning: Exercise that gets your heart rate up (running, cycling, etc.).

Example: "I need to do more cardio. I get out of breath so easily."

Money Slang

Cash / Dough / Bread / Bucks

Meaning: Money.

- Money (physical money, like bills).

Example: "I need some cash for the movies."

Example: *I need to make some bread this summer.*

Bands

Meaning: Stacks of money (originally \$1,000 bands of bills).

- Thousands of dollars (\$1,000+).

Example: "He's making bands with his new job. He's so lucky."

Example: *He's stacking bands*

Dough

Meaning: Money (slang). Similar to "cash."

Example: "I'm trying to make some dough this summer."

Bread

Meaning: Money (slang). Same as "dough."

Example: "I need to save my bread for college."

Bucks

Meaning: Dollars.

Example: "Those shoes cost like 200 bucks. That's so expensive!"

Stack

Meaning: A large amount of money.

Example: "I'm saving a stack for my trip."

Travel & Routine Slang

Getaway

Meaning: A short trip or escape.

- A short vacation or break.

Example: "I need a getaway. I'm so stressed."

Example: *I need a weekend getaway.*

Road trip

Meaning: A trip taken by car, often with friends.

- A long journey by car.

Example: "We're going on a road trip this summer!"

Example: *We're planning a road trip this summer.*

Self-care

Meaning: Deliberate activities to take care of your mental and physical health.

Example: *Tonight is pure self-care—face mask and early bed.*

Trip

Meaning: A vacation or journey.

Example: "We're planning a trip to California."

Vacation Mode

Meaning: The state of being relaxed on vacation.

Example: "I'm on vacation mode. No stress allowed."

DAILY ROUTINE SLANG

Morning Routine

Meaning: The things you do every morning to get ready.

Example: "My morning routine is shower, breakfast, and school."

Night Routine

Meaning: The things you do every night before bed.

Example: "My night routine is skincare, reading, and sleeping."

Self-Care

Meaning: Taking care of your mental and physical health.

Example: "I need to practice more self-care. I'm so stressed."

Dreams & Ambition Slang

Goals

Meaning: Aspirations; also used when something or someone is admirable.

- Things you want to achieve.

Example: "My goals are to get into a good college and travel the world."

Example: *That career path is goals.*

Hustle / Grind

Meaning: Hard, consistent work toward a goal.

- Work hard to achieve your goals.

Example: "I'm always hustling. I want to be successful."

Example: *I'm on my grind every day.*

Vision

Meaning: Long-term plan or clear picture of the future.

Example: *She has a real vision for her future.*

Bag

Meaning: Money or success, especially when obtained through effort ("secure the bag").

Example: *I'm focused on securing the bag.*

Grind

Meaning: Hard work every day.

Example: "I'm on my grind. I'm working hard for my future."

Vision

Meaning: Your plan or dream for the future.

Example: "I have a vision for my life. I know what I want."

Bag

Meaning: Money/success (getting what you want).

Example: "I'm gonna get that bag. I'm going to be successful."

Slang Words for Lifestyle

Here is the list of slang words for Lifestyle with meanings:

1. **Vibe:** A person's emotional state or atmosphere.
2. **Flex:** Showcasing one's wealth or accomplishments.
3. **Wave:** The current trend or movement.
4. **Mood:** A relatable feeling or situation.
5. **Grind:** The daily hustle or routine.
6. **Swag:** Personal style or confidence.
7. **Hustle:** Working hard or chasing goals.
8. **Groove:** A personal rhythm or routine.
9. **Flava:** Unique style or essence.
10. **Steez:** A combination of style and ease.
11. **Juice:** Influence or clout.

12. **Sauce:** A special quality or charm.
13. **Jive:** Personal manner or style.
14. **Flow:** Going with the rhythm or trend.
15. **Stash:** The array of possessions or collections.
16. **Jam:** Favorite thing or activity.
17. **Drift:** A particular way or direction of living.
18. **Spin:** A personal take or version.
19. **Haps:** What's currently happening or trendy?
20. **Zone:** Personal comfort or space.

Use of Lifestyle Slang in Example Sentences

Below are example sentences using the slang term Lifestyle:

1. That's the **vibe** she's going for.
2. Check out his new **flex** with that car.
3. Skinny jeans are not the **wave** anymore.
4. That cozy café is in such a **mood**.
5. He's always on his **grind**, day and night.
6. Her outfit has so much **swag** today.
7. She's always on the **hustle**, making things happen.
8. He's found his **groove** with morning workouts.
9. That song has a unique **flava** to it.
10. His casual attire is pure **steez**.
11. She's got the **juice** in the fashion industry.
12. He's got that special **sauce** in his personality.
13. That old-school **jive** suits him.
14. Just go with the **flow** and enjoy the party.
15. He's proud of his sneaker **stash**.
16. Jazz is her favorite **jam**.
17. He's been on a different **drift** since college.
18. I like your **spin** on this traditional dish.
19. What's the **haps** for tonight?
20. That's her relaxation **zone** after work.

Conversation Samples

“Let’s grab some grub.”

“Your fit is so fire.”

“I’m getting gains.”

“I need to make some cash.”

“I need a getaway.”

“I’m on my grind.”

“That’s the goal.”

PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Saying "Grub"

Pronunciation: GRUB (short, quick "U" sound like "club")

Practice:

✓ "Let's get some GRUB."

Say it 5 times: Grub, grub, grub, grub, grub!

Saying "Drip"

Pronunciation: DRIP (crisp "D" and "P")

Practice:

✓ "You got DRIP!"

Say it 5 times: Drip, drip, drip, drip, drip!

Saying "Gains"

Pronunciation: GAYNS (long "A" sound)

Practice:

✓ "I'm getting GAINS!"

Say it 5 times: Gains, gains, gains, gains, gains!

Saying "Cash"

Pronunciation: CASH (clear "SH" sound)

Practice:

✓ "I need some CASH."

Say it 5 times: Cash, cash, cash, cash, cash!

Saying "Grind"

Pronunciation: GRYND (strong "N" and "D")

Practice:

✓ "I'm on my GRIND."

Say it 5 times: Grind, grind, grind, grind, grind!

Saying "Fit"

Pronunciation: FIT (short, quick vowel)

Practice:

✓ "Your FIT is fire!"

Say it 5 times: Fit, fit, fit, fit, fit!

REAL LIFE CONVERSATIONS

Dialogue 1: Ordering Fast Food

Setting: At a drive thru.

Cashier: "Welcome to Burger King! What can I get for you today?"

You: "Can I get a number one with fries and a large drink?"

Cashier: "Would you like to dine in or takeout?"

You: "Takeout, please. I'm in a hurry."

Cashier: "No problem. That'll be \$8.50."

You: (hands over money) "Here's the cash."

Cashier: "Thanks! Pull up to the next window."

You: (to friend) "I'm so hungry. This grub is gonna be so good."

Friend: "Same. I can't wait to eat."

You: "Drive thru is so convenient. I love it."

Friend: "Me too. Fast and easy."

Dialogue 2: Talking About Money and Saving

Setting: Two friends walking home.

Mia: "I really want those new headphones, but they're so expensive."

Ella: "How much are they?"

Mia: "Like 200 bucks. That's so much money."

Ella: "That's a lot. I'm saving my bread for college."

Mia: "Smart. I should save too. I need to get a job."

Ella: "You should get a side gig. Something easy."

Mia: "I've been thinking about tutoring. I'm good at math."

Ella: "That's perfect! You can make good cash doing that."

Mia: "Yeah, I'm gonna do it. I need to start hustling."

Ella: "Same. We gotta get that bag."

Mia: "Hustle, hustle! We'll be rich one day."

Ella: "Facts! Just keep working hard."

Dialogue 3: Morning Routine Chat

Setting: Getting ready for school.

You: "I'm so tired. I woke up so late."

Sibling: "What's your morning routine? You're always rushing."

You: "Honestly? I roll out of bed, brush my teeth, and go."

Sibling: "LOL. You don't even eat breakfast?"

You: "I grab a snack on the way. It's fine."

Sibling: "That's not healthy! You need to eat."

You: "I know, I know. I need to work on my morning routine."

Sibling: "Wake up earlier. You'll feel better."

You: "You're right. I need to be more organized."

Sibling: "Self-care, right? Start your day right."

You: "You sound like mom. But you're right."

Sibling: "I'm always right. Now hurry up, we're gonna be late!"

You: "Let's go! I'm ready."

Dialogue 4: Complimenting a Friend's Outfit

Setting: At school, before class starts.

Marcus: "Yo, your fit is fire today!"

Jenna: "Thanks! I got this jacket yesterday."

Marcus: "You got drip for real. Where'd you get it?"

Jenna: "I found it at that new store in the mall."

Marcus: "It's so fresh. I need to get one."

Jenna: "You should! It was on sale too."

Marcus: "How much was it?"

Jenna: "Only 50 bucks. That's such a steal!"

Marcus: "Okay, I'm definitely going this weekend."

Jenna: "You gotta get it. It'll look so good on you."

Marcus: "Thanks! You always have the best style."

Jenna: "I try. Good vibes only, right?"

Marcus: "Facts. You look fly as usual."

Dialogue 5: At the Gym

Setting: Two friends working out.

Alex: "Bro, I'm getting so many gains lately."

Jordan: "I can see it! Your arms are looking huge."

Alex: "Thanks! I've been bulking for like two months now."

Jordan: "That's the grind. I need to start bulking too."

Alex: "You should! Just eat more and lift heavy."

Jordan: "I've been doing more cardio. I'm trying to cut."

Alex: "You look good, man. Your pump is looking fire."

Jordan: "Thanks! I feel good. The gym is my happy place."

Alex: "Same. I'm such a gym rat now."

Jordan: "Good. Let's keep it up. We got this."

Dialogue 6: Talking About Dreams and Goals

Setting: Two friends at a coffee shop.

Sophie: "So, what are your goals for this year?"

Daniel: "I want to get into a good college and study business."

Sophie: "That's a good goal. What's your vision for the future?"

Daniel: "I want to start my own business eventually."

Sophie: "That's amazing! You're always hustling."

Daniel: "I'm on my grind. I want to get that bag."

Sophie: "I feel you. My goal is to travel the world."

Daniel: "That's fire! Where do you want to go?"

Sophie: "Everywhere! Europe, Asia, South America."

Daniel: "You'll do it. Just keep working hard."

Sophie: "Thanks. We both have big goals. Let's achieve them!"

Daniel: "Bet. We got this!"

Dialogue 7: Planning a Trip

Setting: Two friends making plans.

Maya: "I need a getaway so bad. I'm so stressed."

Tara: "Same! Where do you want to go?"

Maya: "I was thinking about a road trip this summer."

Tara: "That sounds amazing! Where would we go?"

Maya: "Maybe the coast. We could drive along the highway."

Tara: "I'm so down for that. Road trip with the squad!"

Maya: "We need to save some cash for it though."

Tara: "True. I'm working on my grind. I'll have the bread by then."

Maya: "Bet. We'll make it happen."

Tara: "I'm so excited. I need vacation mode now!"

Maya: "Same. Just a few more months!"

PRACTICE EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete these sentences with the right lifestyle slang word:

1. "I'm so hungry! Let's get some ____."
2. "Your outfit is so fire! You got ____!"
3. "I'm seeing ____ at the gym. My muscles are growing!"
4. "I need some ____ for the movies tonight."
5. "I'm on my _____. I'm working hard for my future."
6. "I love your ____! Where did you get those shoes?"
7. "I need a _____. I'm so stressed."
8. "My _____ is shower, breakfast, and school."
9. "I'm saving my _____ for college."
10. "That's the _____! I want to achieve that too."

Exercise 2: Match the Slang to Its Meaning

Slang Word	Meaning
1. Grub	a. Stylish clothing
2. Drip	b. Money
3. Gains	c. Food
4. Cash	d. Short vacation
5. Getaway	e. Muscle growth
6. Fit	f. Work hard for goals
7. Grind	g. Outfit
8. Bread	h. Money (slang)
9. Munchies	i. Craving for snacks
10. Bucks	j. Dollars

Exercise 3: Choose the Right Slang

Read each situation and choose the best slang word:

Situation 1: You see a friend looking very stylish.

You say: "You've got _____! That outfit is fire!"

- a) Grub
- b) Drip
- c) Gains

Situation 2: You're really hungry and want to eat.

You say: "I'm starving! Let's get some _____."

- a) Grub
- b) Cash
- c) Goals

Situation 3: You're talking about your future plans.

You say: "That's my _____. I want to be successful."

- a) Grind
- b) Goal
- c) Drip

Situation 4: You need money.

You say: "I need to make some _____."

- a) Munchies
- b) Threads
- c) Cash

Situation 5: You're working hard every day.

You say: "I'm on my _____. No days off."

- a) Fit
- b) Grind
- c) Getaway

Exercise 4: Translate to Teen Slang

Change these formal sentences into teen slang:

1. Formal: "I am very hungry. Let us eat some food."
Slang: _____
2. Formal: "Your outfit looks very stylish today."
Slang: _____
3. Formal: "I am going to exercise to build muscle."
Slang: _____
4. Formal: "I need to earn some money."
Slang: _____
5. Formal: "I am working very hard to achieve my goals."
Slang: _____

Exercise 5: Create Your Own Dialogue

Write a short dialogue for each situation. Use lifestyle slang!

Situation 1: You and a friend are ordering food.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 2: You're complimenting a friend's outfit.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 3: You're talking about fitness and working out.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Situation 4: You're talking about your goals for the future.

You: _____

Friend: _____

You: _____

Friend: _____

Exercise 6: Pronunciation Practice

Say these sentences out loud 5 times each with the right stress!

1. "Let's get some GRUB!"
2. "You got DRIP!"
3. "I'm getting GAINS!"
4. "I need some CASH."
5. "I'm on my GRIND."
6. "Your FIT is fire."
7. "I'm saving my BREAD."
8. "I need a GETAWAY."
9. "I'm on VACATION MODE."
10. "That's the GOAL!"

Chapter 5 Summary

You can now talk about food, clothes, the gym, money, travel, and ambition the way many American teens do. These words appear constantly in everyday conversation and on social media. Use them naturally and they will help you sound current and connected.

CHAPTER 6

SOCIAL MEDIA, INTERNET & DIGITAL SLANG

6.1 Introduction

The internet has created a huge amount of new English vocabulary. Words and expressions that were once limited to online communities are now commonly heard in everyday conversations.

Social media slang is especially common among young people. You may hear these expressions on TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, Facebook, X, Snapchat, Discord, WhatsApp, and other platforms.

However, online English is usually **informal English**. It should not automatically be used in formal academic writing, job applications, official letters, or professional reports.

Learning Goal

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- understand common social-media slang;
- recognize abbreviations in online conversations;
- understand digital conversations and comments;
- use common expressions naturally;
- distinguish informal internet English from formal English.

6.2 DM

Meaning

DM means **Direct Message**.

A direct message is a private message sent to another person through a social-media platform.

Usage

People use **DM** when they want someone to communicate privately instead of publicly.

Examples

“DM me when you get home.”

“I sent you a DM yesterday.”

“Can you DM me the address?”

Explanation

If someone says:

“DM me.”

they are asking you to send them a private message.

Real-Life Conversation

Mike: Can you send me the photos?

John: Sure. Where should I send them?

Mike: Just DM me on Instagram.

John: Okay. I'll send them tonight.

Similar Expressions

- message me
- text me
- send me a private message

Formal Alternative

Instead of:

“DM me the information.”

In formal communication:

“Please send me the information privately.”

6.3 LOL

Meaning

LOL means **Laughing Out Loud**.

It is commonly used online to show that something is funny.

Usage

LOL is mainly used in text messages, comments, chats, and social media.

Examples

“That was hilarious LOL.”

“LOL, I can't believe you did that.”

Explanation

LOL does not necessarily mean that the person is literally laughing loudly. It can simply show amusement or make a message sound lighter.

Real-Life Conversation

Sarah: I walked into the wrong classroom today.

Maya: LOL! Seriously?

Sarah: Yes! Everyone looked at me.

Maya: That's hilarious.

Similar Expressions

- haha
- hahaha
- lmao — stronger and more informal
- that's funny

Caution

Avoid LOL in formal academic or professional writing.

6.4 OMG

Meaning

OMG means **Oh My God**.

It is used to express:

- surprise;
- excitement;
- shock;
- disbelief.

Examples

“OMG! You won!”

“OMG, look at this!”

“OMG! That's unbelievable.”

Real-Life Conversation

Anna: Guess what?

Lisa: What?

Anna: I got accepted!

Lisa: OMG! Congratulations!

Anna: Thank you!

6.5 BTW

Meaning

BTW means **By The Way**.

It is used when you want to introduce additional information that is related to the conversation but is not the main topic.

Example

“BTW, are you coming tomorrow?”

Explanation

Imagine that you are talking about school:

Tom: Did you finish your assignment?

David: Yes.

Tom: BTW, did you talk to the teacher?

The word **BTW** introduces another subject.

Real-Life Conversation

Alex: Are you going to the library?

Brian: Yes.

Alex: BTW, can you bring my notebook?

Brian: Sure.

6.6 TBH

Meaning

TBH means **To Be Honest**.

It introduces an honest opinion or statement.

Examples

“TBH, I don't like that movie.”

“TBH, you did a great job.”

Real-Life Conversation

Sam: What do you think about my presentation?

David: TBH, it was really good.

Sam: Thanks!

6.7 IDK

Meaning

IDK means **I Don't Know**.

Examples

“IDK where he went.”

“IDK what happened.”

Real-Life Conversation

Tom: Where's Sarah?

Mike: IDK.

Tom: Did she tell you anything?

Mike: No, she didn't.

Formal Alternative

“I don't know.”

The abbreviation **IDK** is mainly appropriate for informal digital communication.

6.8 GOAT

Meaning

GOAT means **Greatest Of All Time**.

It is used to describe someone considered exceptionally successful or talented.

Examples

“Many fans call him the GOAT.”

“She's the GOAT of basketball.”

Explanation

GOAT is normally written in capital letters because it is an abbreviation.

It does **not** mean the animal in this context.

Real-Life Conversation

John: Who's your favorite football player?

Mike: Definitely Messi.

John: You think he's the GOAT?

Mike: Absolutely.

6.9 VIRAL

Meaning

When online content becomes **viral**, it spreads extremely quickly and receives a very large amount of attention.

Examples

“Her video went viral.”

“That post became viral overnight.”

Explanation

A viral video may receive millions of views, shares, comments, or reposts.

Real-Life Conversation

Sarah: Did you see that video?

Maya: Which one?

Sarah: The dancing video.

Maya: Yeah! It's everywhere.

Sarah: It went viral yesterday.

6.10 GHOST

Meaning

To **ghost** someone means to suddenly stop communicating with them without explaining why.

Examples

- “He ghosted me.”
- “Why did she ghost you?”

Usage: Ghosting can happen in friendships, dating, professional communication, or online relationships.

Real-Life Conversation

Mike: What happened to Daniel?

John: I don't know.

Mike: Didn't he usually message you?

John: Yeah, but he suddenly stopped replying.

Mike: He ghosted you?

John: I guess so.

Important Note: Ghosting is generally considered negative behavior because the other person is given no explanation.

6.11 FOMO

Meaning

FOMO means **Fear Of Missing Out**.

It describes the feeling that you are missing an exciting experience while other people are enjoying it.

Example

“I went to the party because of FOMO.”

Explanation

You may not really want to attend an event, but you worry that everyone else will have fun without you.

Real-Life Conversation

Alex: Are you going to the concert?

Sam: I wasn't planning to.

Alex: So why did you buy a ticket?

Sam: Honestly? FOMO.

Alex: Haha. I understand.

6.12 TROLL

Meaning

A **troll** is someone who deliberately provokes, annoys, or insults people online in order to get a reaction.

Example

“Don't respond to that troll.”

Explanation

A troll may post something deliberately offensive or ridiculous simply because they want people to argue with them.

Real-Life Conversation

David: Someone keeps insulting everyone in the comments.

James: Don't take it seriously.

David: Why?

James: He's probably just trolling.

6.13 CLICKBAIT

Meaning

Clickbait is online content designed mainly to make people click on it, often using exaggerated or misleading headlines.

Example

✓ “That headline is clickbait.”

Common Pattern

A headline might say: “You Won't Believe What Happened Next!”

The purpose is to make people curious enough to click.

6.14 FINAL PRACTICE

Complete the sentences:

1. Send me a _____ if you want to talk privately.
2. _____! I can't believe you won.
3. _____, I don't agree with you.
4. I don't know. _____.
5. His video went _____.
6. She stopped answering all my messages. She _____ me.
7. I went to the event because of _____.
8. Don't argue with that person. He's just a _____.

Real-Life Challenge

Create a five-minute conversation between two friends discussing social media. Use at least **ten expressions** from this chapter.

CHAPTER 7

SCHOOL, WORK & PROFESSIONAL INFORMAL ENGLISH

7.1 Introduction

Students and workers often use informal expressions when speaking with friends, classmates, teachers, and coworkers.

Knowing these expressions helps learners understand natural conversations.

However, remember:

Informal English is not always appropriate in formal writing.

7.2 ACE IT

Meaning

To **ace** something means to do extremely well.

Example

✓ “I aced my English exam.”

Explanation

If you receive an excellent result on a test, you can say that you **aced** it.

Real-Life Conversation

Teacher: How was your exam?

Student: It was easy.

Teacher: Really?

Student: Yeah. I think I aced it.

7.3 CRAM

Meaning

To **cram** means to study a lot in a short period, usually immediately before an exam.

Example “I stayed up all night cramming for the exam.”

Explanation

A student who waits until the last minute and studies intensely may say:

“I’m cramming.”

Conversation

Mike: Did you study for tomorrow's test?

John: Not really.

Mike: What are you going to do?

John: I'll cram tonight.

Mike: Good luck!

7.4 BOMB

Meaning

To **bomb** an exam, presentation, or performance means to perform very badly.

Example: “I bombed the test.”

Conversation

Sarah: How did your exam go?

Anna: Terrible.

Sarah: Really?

Anna: Yeah. I totally bombed it.

7.5 POP QUIZ

Meaning

A **pop quiz** is a short test given unexpectedly.

Example

✓ “The teacher gave us a pop quiz.”

Conversation

Student 1: Why is everyone studying?

Student 2: We have a pop quiz.

Student 1: What? Nobody told me!

7.6 TOUCH BASE

Meaning

To **touch base** means to communicate briefly about something.

Example

✓ “Let's touch base tomorrow.”

Usage

This expression is common in workplaces.

Conversation

Manager: Do you have time tomorrow?

Employee: Yes.

Manager: Great. Let's touch base about the project.

Employee: Sounds good.

7.7 ON THE SAME PAGE

Meaning

To be **on the same page** means to have the same understanding or expectations.

Example

✓ “Let's meet so we're all on the same page.”

Explanation

Imagine several people working on one project. If everyone understands the plan, they are **on the same page**.

Conversation

Manager: Before we begin, let's make sure we're on the same page.

Employee: Good idea.

7.8 IN THE LOOP

Meaning

To **keep someone in the loop** means to keep them informed.

Example

✓ “Please keep me in the loop.”

Conversation

David: Did the manager approve the project?

John: Not yet.

David: Please keep me in the loop.

John: Sure.

7.9 I'M SWAMPED

Meaning

“I'm swamped” means **I am extremely busy**.

Example

“Sorry, I can't help right now. I'm swamped.”

Conversation

Friend: Want to go for coffee?

Sam: I can't today.

Friend: Why?

Sam: I'm completely swamped with work.

7.10 CRUNCH TIME

Meaning

Crunch time is a period when something must be completed quickly, usually because of an approaching deadline.

Example

“It's crunch time.”

Conversation

Student: When is the assignment due?

Friend: Tomorrow.

Student: Tomorrow?!

Friend: Yep. It's crunch time.

7.11 BURNOUT

Meaning

Burnout describes extreme exhaustion caused by prolonged stress or excessive work.

Example

“Working without rest can lead to burnout.”

Explanation

Burnout is stronger than simply being tired.

Someone may feel mentally and physically exhausted after a long period of pressure.

7.12 MY BAD

Meaning

My bad is an informal way of admitting a small mistake.

Example “My bad. I forgot the meeting.”

Conversation

John: You sent me the wrong document.

Mike: Oh, my bad!

John: No worries.

7.13 NO WORRIES

Meaning

No worries means “That's okay” or “Don't worry about it.”

Example

A: Sorry I'm late.

B: No worries.

7.14 WRAP IT UP

Meaning

To **wrap something up** means to finish it.

Example

✓ “Let's wrap up the meeting.”

Conversation

Manager: Does anyone have any final questions?

Employee: No.

Manager: Okay. Let's wrap it up.

7.15 FORMAL VS INFORMAL

Informal	Formal
My bad	I apologize
No worries	That's perfectly fine
Touch base	Communicate
I'm swamped	I am extremely busy
Wrap it up	Conclude
ASAP	As soon as possible

Chapter Challenge

Write two conversations:

Conversation A: Two students preparing for an exam.

Conversation B: Two coworkers discussing a project.

Use at least **ten expressions** from this chapter.

CHAPTER 8

DATING, RELATIONSHIPS & SOCIAL INTERACTION SLANG

8.1 Introduction

People use many informal expressions when talking about friendship, attraction, dating, communication, and relationships.

These expressions are highly dependent on context. Some are playful, while others can describe serious relationship problems.

8.2 CRUSH

Meaning

A **crush** is someone you are romantically attracted to, especially when the relationship has not yet developed.

Example

“I have a crush on someone in my class.”

Conversation

Mike: Why are you always smiling when Sarah walks in?

John: Nothing.

Mike: Come on. You have a crush on her, don't you?

John: Maybe.

8.3 INTO SOMEONE

Meaning

If you are **into someone**, you are interested in them romantically.

Example

“I think she's really into him.”

Conversation

Anna: Does James like Lisa?

Maya: I think he's really into her.

8.4 HIT ON

Meaning

To **hit on someone** means to flirt with them or show romantic interest.

Example “Someone was hitting on me at the party.”

Explanation

This expression is informal and usually describes direct romantic attention.

8.5 CHEMISTRY

Meaning

Chemistry describes a natural connection or attraction between two people.

Example

“They have great chemistry.”

Explanation

Chemistry does not necessarily mean that two people are already dating. It means they interact naturally and seem strongly connected.

8.6 ASK SOMEONE OUT

Meaning

To **ask someone out** means to invite them on a date.

Example

“He finally asked her out.”

Conversation

David: Did you talk to Emma?

James: Yes.

David: Did you ask her out?

James: Yes! We're going for coffee Saturday.

8.7 GO OUT

Meaning

Go out can mean to date someone.

Example

“They've been going out for six months.”

Important

“Go out” can also simply mean leaving home.

“I'm going out tonight.”

Context tells you which meaning is intended.

8.8 EX

Meaning

An **ex** is a former romantic partner.

Example

“My ex lives in another city.”

8.9 BREAK UP

Meaning

To **break up** means to end a romantic relationship.

Example

“They broke up last month.”

Conversation

Sam: Are John and Lisa still together?

Mike: No.

Sam: Really?

Mike: Yeah. They broke up.

8.10 GET BACK TOGETHER

Meaning

To restart a romantic relationship after breaking up.

Example

“They broke up last year but got back together.”

8.11 LEFT ON READ

Meaning

To be **left on read** means someone has seen your message but has not replied.

Example

“She left me on read.”

Conversation

Tom: Did Sarah reply?

Alex: No.

Tom: Did she see the message?

Alex: Yeah.

Tom: So she left you on read?

Alex: Exactly.

8.12 DOUBLE TEXT

Meaning

To **double text** means sending another message before receiving a reply to your previous message.

Example

“I don't want to double text him.”

8.13 DRY TEXTING

Meaning

Dry texting means sending short, unenthusiastic, or boring replies.

Example

“He only says 'okay' and 'yeah.' He's dry texting.”

Conversation

Maya: How is your conversation going?

Lina: Terrible.

Maya: Why?

Lina: I write paragraphs and he just says “k.”

Maya: That's some serious dry texting.

8.14 RED FLAG

Meaning

A **red flag** is a warning sign that something may be wrong.

Examples

“Constant lying is a red flag.”

“Being disrespectful to people is a major red flag.”

Real-Life Conversation

A: He gets angry whenever I talk to my friends.

B: That's a red flag.

8.15 GREEN FLAG

Meaning

A **green flag** is a positive sign that someone has a healthy or desirable quality.

Example: “Respecting boundaries is a green flag.”

8.16 TOXIC

Meaning

Toxic describes behavior, relationships, or environments that are consistently harmful or unhealthy.

Example

“They left a toxic relationship.”

Important Note

“Toxic” is sometimes overused online. It should describe genuinely harmful patterns, not simply disagreement.

8.17 GHOSTING

Meaning

Ghosting means suddenly ending communication without explanation.

Example

“He ghosted me after our second date.”

8.18 SITUATIONSHIP

Meaning

A **situationship** is an informal term for a romantic relationship that is more than friendship but has no clearly defined status.

Example: “We’re not officially dating. We’re in a situationship.”

Real-Life Conversation

Maya: So, are you two dating?

Lina: Not exactly.

Maya: Then what are you?

Lina: Honestly, I don’t know.

Maya: A situationship?

Lina: Exactly.

8.19 IMPORTANT LANGUAGE NOTE

Some relationship expressions can have sexual or sensitive meanings depending on context. Learners should understand an expression before using it.

For example, **hook up** can have different meanings in different contexts and may refer to a casual sexual encounter. Because of this ambiguity, learners should be particularly careful with it.

Chapter Challenge

Write a conversation between two friends discussing a new relationship.

Include:

- crush
- chemistry
- ask out
- red flag
- green flag
- ghosting
- situationship
- left on read

Then explain each expression used.

CHAPTER 9

MONEY, SHOPPING & HUSTLE SLANG

9.1 Introduction

Money has its own informal vocabulary in American English.

People use these expressions in everyday conversations, movies, music, social media, workplaces, and shopping situations.

9.2 BUCKS

Meaning

Bucks is an informal word for dollars.

Example

“This shirt costs thirty bucks.”

Explanation

“Bucks” is casual. It should normally be avoided in formal financial documents.

Conversation

Customer: How much is this?

Seller: Thirty bucks.

Customer: Can you give me a discount?

9.3 DOUGH

Meaning

Dough is informal slang for money.

Example

“I need to save some dough.”

Conversation

Mike: Are you buying a new phone?

John: I want to.

Mike: What's stopping you?

John: I don't have enough dough.

9.4 BROKE

Meaning

Broke means having little or no money available.

Example

“I’m broke until payday.”

Conversation

Sarah: Want to go to a restaurant?

Anna: Maybe next week.

Sarah: Why?

Anna: I’m broke right now.

9.5 LOADED

Meaning

Loaded can mean extremely wealthy.

Example

“That guy is loaded.”

Important

“Loaded” has several meanings in English. Context determines whether it refers to money or something else.

9.6 MAKE BANK

Meaning

To **make bank** means to earn a lot of money.

Example “She made bank selling products online.”

Conversation

John: How was your business this month?

Mike: Great.

John: Really?

Mike: Yeah, I made bank.

9.7 SPLURGE

Meaning

To **splurge** means to spend more money than usual on something enjoyable or special.

Example

“I decided to splurge on a new computer.”

Explanation

Splurging is usually an occasional decision rather than normal spending.

9.8 RIP-OFF

Meaning

A **rip-off** is something that costs far more than it is worth.

Example

“That price is a rip-off.”

Conversation

Customer: How much is the ticket?

Friend: \$100.

Customer: For that seat?

Friend: Yeah.

Customer: That's a rip-off!

9.9 DEAL

Meaning

A **deal** is a good price or offer.

Example

“I got a great deal on these shoes.”

9.10 A STEAL

Meaning

If something is **a steal**, it is available at an extremely good price.

Example

“I bought this laptop for \$300. It was a steal.”

9.11 PRICEY

Meaning

Pricey means expensive.

Example

“That restaurant is pretty pricey.”

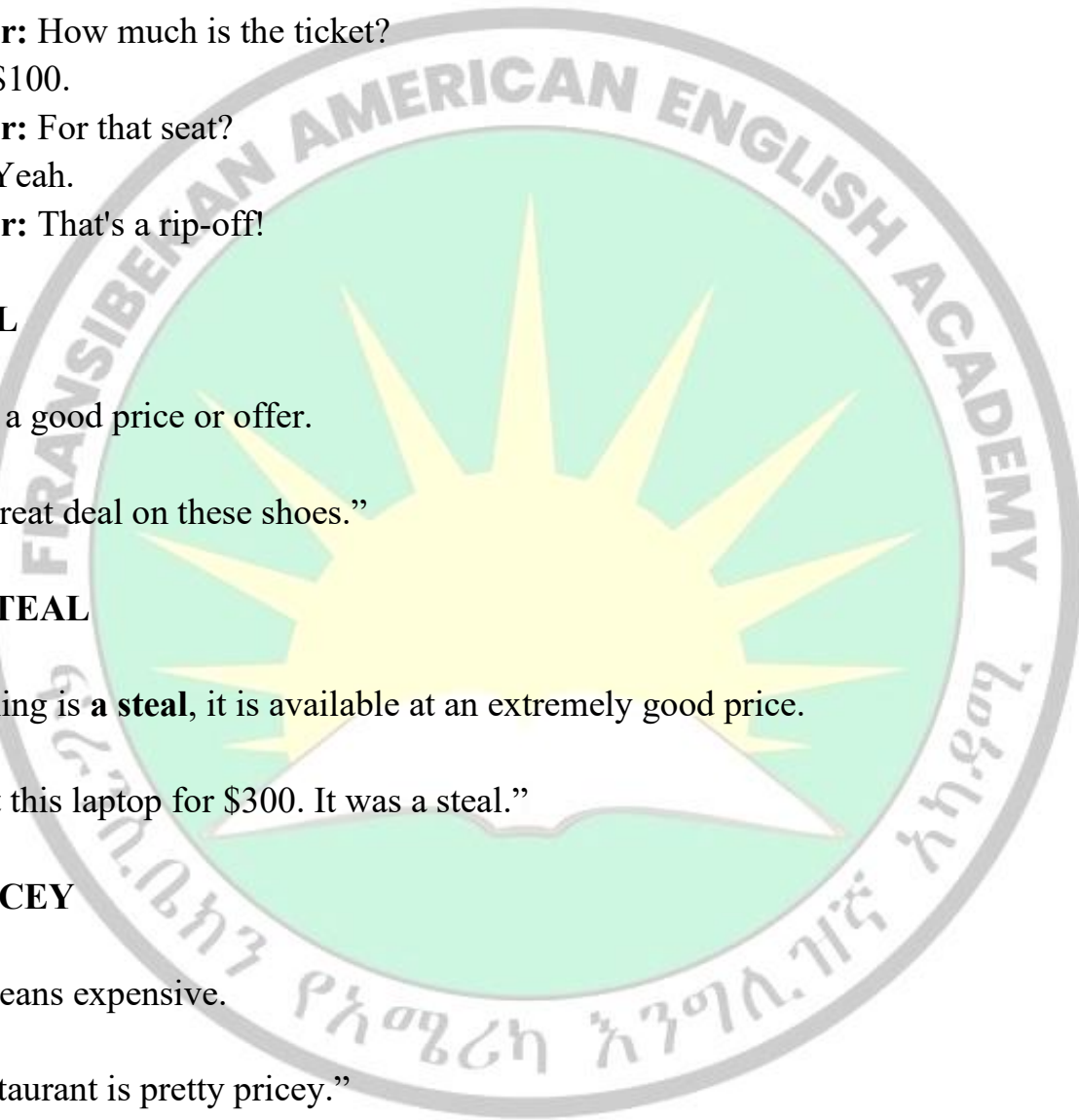
Conversation

Tom: Let's eat there.

Alex: Isn't it expensive?

Tom: A little.

Alex: Then let's find somewhere less pricey.



9.12 HUSTLE

Meaning

Hustle can mean working hard, especially to make money or achieve something.

Example

“She's always hustling.”

Explanation

Hustle often communicates energy, determination, and persistence.

9.13 SIDE HUSTLE

Meaning

A **side hustle** is an additional way of earning money besides one's main job.

Examples

“Teaching online is my side hustle.”

“He has a full-time job and a photography side hustle.”

9.14 GRIND

Meaning

Grind refers to persistent hard work toward a goal.

Example

“I'm on my grind.”

Conversation

Friend: You haven't been going out lately.

Student: I know.

Friend: What's going on?

Student: I'm on my grind. I need to focus on my studies.

9.15 GIG

Meaning

A **gig** is a temporary job or paid task.

Example

“I got a weekend gig.”

Note

“Gig” is especially common when discussing freelance, temporary, creative, or independent work.

9.16 SHOPPING CONVERSATION

Customer: How much are these shoes?

Seller: Forty bucks.

Customer: That's a little pricey.

Seller: They're on sale today.

Customer: How much after the discount?

Seller: Thirty dollars.

Customer: That's a deal.

Seller: Want them?

Customer: Absolutely.

Chapter Challenge

Create a conversation between:

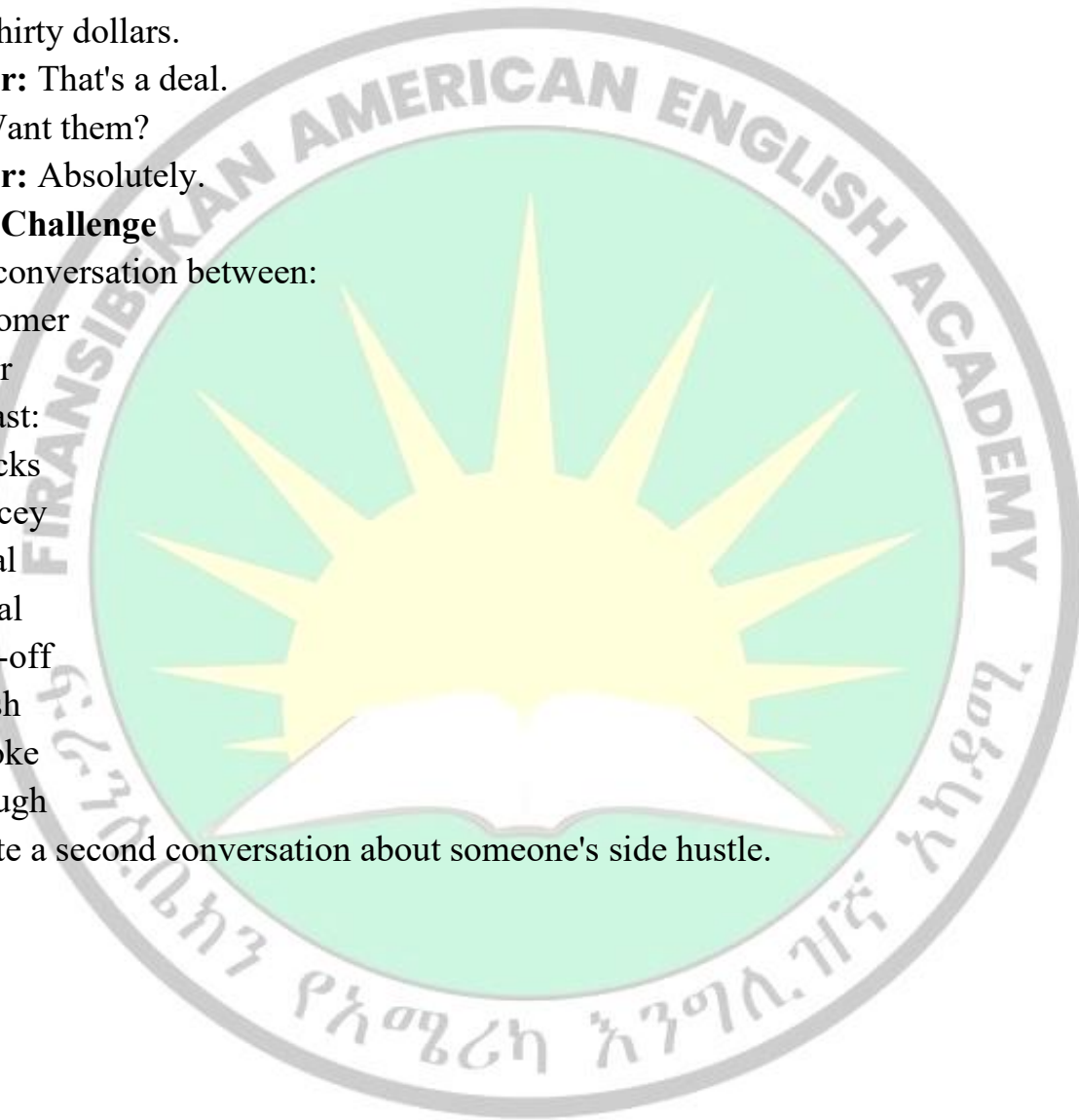
A: a customer

B: a seller

Use at least:

- bucks
- pricey
- deal
- steal
- rip-off
- cash
- broke
- dough

Then write a second conversation about someone's side hustle.



CHAPTER 10

MODERN AMERICAN IDIOMS & CONVERSATIONAL EXPRESSIONS

10.1 Introduction

Natural American English is not only about slang.

Native speakers also use idioms, conversational expressions, fillers, shortened phrases, and informal responses.

These expressions can make your English sound more natural when used appropriately.

10.2 WHAT'S UP?

Meaning

What's up? is an informal greeting.

It can mean:

- How are you?
- What's happening?
- What's new?

Example

“Hey, what's up?”

Conversation

John: Hey, what's up?

Mike: Not much. How about you?

John: I'm good.

10.3 MY BAD

Meaning

“My bad” means “It was my mistake.”

Example

“My bad. I sent you the wrong file.”

Usage

Use it for small mistakes in informal situations.

Do not normally use it in a formal apology.

Formal:

“I apologize for the mistake.”

Informal:

“My bad.”

10.4 NO BIG DEAL

Meaning

Something is **no big deal** when it is not serious or important.

Example

“Don't worry. It's no big deal.”

Conversation

A: Sorry I forgot your book.

B: No big deal. Bring it tomorrow.

10.5 HANG ON

Meaning

Hang on means wait for a short time.

Example

“Hang on a second.”

Conversation

A: Can you help me?

B: Hang on. I'll be there in a minute.

10.6 GIVE ME A BREAK

Meaning

This expression can communicate disbelief, frustration, or disagreement.

Example

“You expect me to finish all that in ten minutes? Give me a break!”

Important

Tone is extremely important. Depending on how it is said, it can sound humorous or rude.

10.7 COME ON

Meaning

Come on has several meanings.

It can mean:

1. Hurry.
2. Encourage someone.
3. Express disbelief.
4. Express frustration.

Examples

“Come on! We're late.”

“Come on, you can do it!”

“Oh, come on! That's not fair.”

Explanation

The meaning depends heavily on tone and context.

10.8 YOU BET

Meaning

“You bet” can mean:

- definitely;
- certainly;
- you're welcome.

Conversation

A: Can you help me?

B: You bet.

10.9 SOUNDS GOOD

Meaning

“Sounds good” means that you agree with a suggestion or plan.

Example

A: Let's meet at six.

B: Sounds good.

10.10 BREAK THE ICE

Meaning

To **break the ice** means to make people feel more comfortable when they first meet.

Example

“The teacher told a joke to break the ice.”

Real-Life Conversation

Teacher: Since you're meeting each other for the first time, let's play a quick game to break the ice.

Student: Sounds fun!

10.11 HIT THE NAIL ON THE HEAD

Meaning

To **hit the nail on the head** means to describe or identify something exactly.

Example

“You hit the nail on the head.”

Conversation

A: I think students are tired because they don't get enough rest.

B: You hit the nail on the head.

10.12 UNDER THE WEATHER

Meaning

To feel **under the weather** means to feel slightly sick or unwell.

Example

“I'm feeling under the weather today.”

Conversation

Friend: Are you coming to class?

Student: I don't think so. I'm feeling under the weather.

10.13 PIECE OF CAKE

Meaning

A **piece of cake** is something very easy.

Example

“The test was a piece of cake.”

Conversation

A: Was the assignment difficult?

B: Not at all. It was a piece of cake.

10.14 ONCE IN A BLUE MOON

Meaning

Something that happens **once in a blue moon** happens very rarely.

Example

“I eat fast food once in a blue moon.”

10.15 COST AN ARM AND A LEG

Meaning

Something that **costs an arm and a leg** is extremely expensive.

Example

“That car costs an arm and a leg.”

Conversation

A: How much is the apartment?

B: \$2,500 a month.

A: Wow! That's going to cost an arm and a leg.

10.16 SPILL THE BEANS

Meaning

To **spill the beans** means to reveal secret information.

Example

“Come on, spill the beans! What happened?”

Conversation

Maya: I know something happened yesterday.

Lina: Who told you?

Maya: Just tell me!

Lina: Fine. I'll spill the beans.

10.17 LET THE CAT OUT OF THE BAG

Meaning

To accidentally reveal a secret.

Example

“He let the cat out of the bag about the surprise party.”

Difference

Both **spill the beans** and **let the cat out of the bag** can mean revealing a secret.

10.18 CONVERSATION FILLERS

Native speakers often use small expressions while thinking.

“**You know...**”

Example:

“You know, I think you're right.”

“I mean...”

Example:

“I mean, we could try again.”

“Actually...”

Example:

“Actually, I changed my mind.”

“Basically...”

Example:

“Basically, we need more time.”

“Like...”

Example:

“It was, like, really expensive.”

Important Note

These expressions are common in spontaneous speech, but using too many fillers can make your English unclear.

10.19 AGREEING NATURALLY

Instead of always saying:

“I agree.”

You can say:

- Exactly!
- Absolutely!
- Definitely!
- For sure!
- You're right.
- That's true.
- Totally.
- I know, right?

Conversation

A: That movie was amazing.

B: Absolutely!

A: The acting was incredible.

B: Exactly!

10.20 DISAGREEING NATURALLY

You can disagree politely with:

- Not really.
- I'm not sure about that.
- I don't think so.
- That's not how I see it.
- I'm not convinced.

Conversation

A: I think online classes are always better.

B: I'm not sure about that.

A: Why?

B: I think it depends on the student.

10.21 COMPLETE REAL-LIFE CONVERSATION

David: Hey, what's up?

James: Not much. I'm feeling a little under the weather.

David: Oh, really?

James: Yeah, but it's no big deal.

David: Are you still coming to the meeting?

James: Give me a minute. Let me check.

David: Sure.

James: Actually, I think I'll stay home.

David: No worries.

James: Thanks.

David: You know, you should get some rest.

James: You're right.

David: We'll talk tomorrow.

James: Sounds good.

10.22 FINAL PRACTICE

Exercise A — Match

Match each expression with its meaning.

1. What's up?
2. No big deal.
3. Under the weather.
4. Piece of cake.
5. Break the ice.
6. Spill the beans.
7. Sounds good.
8. Hang on.
 - A. Wait
 - B. Very easy
 - C. Reveal a secret
 - D. Casual greeting
 - E. Feel slightly sick
 - F. Not serious
 - G. Agree with a suggestion
 - H. Make people comfortable

Exercise B — Create Your Own Sentences

Write one natural sentence for each:

1. My bad
2. Come on
3. You bet
4. Once in a blue moon
5. Hit the nail on the head
6. Cost an arm and a leg
7. Basically
8. Actually

Exercise C — Final Speaking Challenge

Create a **three-minute conversation** with a partner.

Your conversation must include:

- 2 greetings;
- 3 idioms;
- 3 slang expressions;
- 2 agreement expressions;
- 2 disagreement expressions;
- 2 conversation fillers;
- 1 apology;
- 1 suggestion;
- 1 humorous expression.

FINAL LESSON

The purpose of learning slang and informal expressions is **not to force slang into every sentence**.

A strong English speaker knows how to change style depending on the situation.

Formal situation → formal English

Classroom discussion → appropriate academic English

Conversation with friends → informal English

Online chat → digital/informal English

The real skill is not simply knowing slang.

The real skill is knowing when, where, why, and how to use it.

Glossary of Key Terms

A quick alphabetical reference of the highest-frequency slang covered in this book. For full explanations and examples, return to the relevant topic.

Slang	Simple Meaning
AFK	Away from keyboard
Banger	Excellent, energetic song
Bestie / BFF	Best friend
Bounce	Leave
Cap / No cap	Lie / No lie
Chill	Relax; also calm
Cringe	Embarrassing / awkward
Drip / Fit	Style / Outfit
Fam	Close friends like family
Fire / Lit	Excellent, exciting
FOMO	Fear of missing out
GG	Good game
Ghost	Suddenly cut off contact
Gains	Fitness progress
Grub	Food
Hustle / Grind	Hard work toward goals
Kick it / Hang out	Spend time casually
Noob	Inexperienced player
Pop quiz	Surprise test
Ride or die	Extremely loyal friend
Salty	Bitter or annoyed
Shook	Shocked / shaken
Slay	Do something impressively
Squad / Crew	Friend group
Stoked / Pumped	Very excited
TBH	To be honest
Turnt	Hyped up / party energy
Wiped / Dead	Exhausted
YOLO	You only live once

APPENDIX A: SLANG DON'TS

Words to Avoid

Some slang words are offensive or outdated. Here's what to avoid:

Offensive Words (NEVER USE)

- Racial slurs Never use any word that insults someone's race or ethnicity.
- Homophobic slurs Never use words that insult someone's sexual orientation.
- Sexist language Never use words that insult someone's gender.

Outdated Words (Sounds Old)

- Groovy Very 1960s. No one says this anymore.
- Radical Very 1980s. Sounds old.
- Gnarly Very 1980s. Sounds old.
- On fleek Very 2010s. Has been replaced by "on point" or just "fire."

APPENDIX B: QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

All Slang Words by Category

Friendship

BFF, Bestie, Fam, Squad, Homie, Ride or Die, Bro, Crew, Clan

Greetings: Wassup, Sup, Yo, What's Good

Compliments: Slay, Facts, No Cap

Texting: BRB, IDK, LOL, OMG, SMH, TBH, RN, G2G, TTYL, IKR

Youth Life

High School: Freshman, Sophomore, Junior, Senior, The Halls, Lunch Table

Teachers: Hard Teacher, Easy A, Pop Quiz, Group Project

Weekend: Kick It, Chill, Hang Out, Bounce

Social Media: Post, Scroll, Like, Follow, DM, Story, Streak

Home Life: 'Rents, Curfew, Grounded, Chores

Jobs: Hustle, Side Gig, Minimum Wage, Clock In/Out

Romance: Crush, Smash, Talking, Ghost, Simp

Peer Pressure: FOMO, YOLO, Fit In

Emotions

Happy: Lit, Fire, Stoked, Pumped, Vibing, On Cloud Nine

Sad: Bummed, Down, In My Feels, Blue

Angry: Salty, Heated, Fed Up, Extra

Nervous: Shook, Butterflies, Freaking Out

Embarrassed: Cringe, Awkward, Facepalm

Surprised: No Way, For Real, Dead

Calm: Chill, Cool, Good Vibes, Zen

Tired: Wiped, Dead, Zonked, Burned Out

Entertainment

Movies: Spoiler, Cliffhanger, Flop, Blockbuster, Must See

Music: Banger, Vibe, Hit, Drop, Beat, Oldie, Playlist

Gaming: Noob, Pro, Lag, AFK, GG, EZ, Pwned, Nerf

Binge Watching: Binge, Marathon

Concerts: Sold Out, Pit, Headliner, Mosh Pit

YouTube: Sub, Like, Comment, Reaction, Vlog, Unboxing

Parties: Lit, Turnt, Bash, House Party, Rager

Lifestyle

Food: Grub, Munchies, Snack, Bite, Treat, Yummy, Comfort Food

Eating Out: Takeout, Dine In, Drive thru, Menu, Order

Fashion: Drip, Fit, Fresh, Clean, Swag, Threads, Fly

Fitness: Gym Rat, Pump, Gains, Workout, Bulk, Cut, Cardio

Money: Cash, Dough, Bread, Bucks, Bands, Stack

Travel: Trip, Getaway, Road Trip, Vacation Mode

Routine: Morning Routine, Night Routine, Self care

Dreams: Goals, Hustle, Grind, Vision, Bag

APPENDIX C: GLOSSARY

Slang Word Meaning

AFK Away from keyboard

Banger A really good song

Bash A party

Bestie Best friend

BFF Best friends forever

Binge Watch many episodes in one sitting

Blockbuster A very successful movie

Bounce Leave quickly

BRB Be right back

Bro A male friend or close buddy

Bucks Dollars

Bummed Disappointed or sad

Cash Money

Chill Relax

Clean Neat and stylish

Cliffhanger An ending that leaves you wanting more

Cringe Embarrassing or awkward

Crush Someone you like romantically

Curfew The time you must be home by

Dead Very tired or very funny

DM Direct message

Dough Money

Down Feeling sad

Drip Stylish clothing

Drive thru Ordering food from your car

EZ Easy (gaming)
Extra Being dramatic
Facts I agree / that's true
Fam Friends who feel like family
Fed Up Tired of something
Fire Really good or cool
Fit Outfit
Flop An unsuccessful movie
Fly Cool and stylish
FOMO Fear of missing out
For Real Seriously
Fresh New and stylish
G2G Got to go
Gains Muscle growth
Getaway A short vacation
GG Good game
Ghost Suddenly stop responding to someone
Goals Things you want to achieve
Gonna Going to
Good Vibes Positive energy
Grind Hard work every day
Grounded Being punished by parents
Grub Food
Gym Rat Someone who goes to the gym a lot
Hang Out Spend time with friends
Heated Very angry
Hit A very popular song

Homie A close friend
Hustle Work hard to make money
IDK I don't know
IKR I know, right?
Junior 11th grader
Kick It Hang out with friends
Lag Slow internet connection (gaming)
Lit Really good or exciting
LOL Laughing out loud
Mosh Pit Chaotic area at a concert
No Cap No lie / for real
No Way I don't believe it
Noob A beginner (gaming)
OMG Oh my god
On Cloud Nine Extremely happy
Pit Area in front of concert stage
Pop Quiz A surprise test
Post Put online
Pro Professional (gaming)
Pumped Very excited
Pwned Defeated (gaming)
Rager A wild party
'Rents Parents
Ride or Die A loyal friend
RN Right now
Salty Annoyed or bitter
Senior 12th grader

Side Gig A small job for extra money

Slay Look amazing / do something well

SMH Shaking my head

Snack Small amount of food (or attractive person)

Sold Out No tickets left

Sophomore 10th grader

Spoiler Someone who tells the ending

Squad Group of close friends

Stoked Very excited

Story Temporary social media post

Swag Style and confidence

TBH To be honest

Takeout Food you take home

Threads Clothes

Trip A vacation

Trippin' Being ridiculous

TTYL Talk to you later

Turnt Crazy and fun

Vibe Feeling or mood

Vibing Enjoying the atmosphere

Vision Plan for the future

Vlog Video blog

Wanna Want to

Wiped Extremely tired

YOLO You only live once

Yummy Delicious

Zen Completely calm

APPENDIX D: PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Key Sounds to Master

The "T" Sound

American English often makes "t" sound like a quick "d" in the middle of words

"Water" → "wader"

"Better" → "beder"

Linking Words

Words connect together in natural speech

"Got you" → "Gotcha"

"Want to" → "Wanna"

"Going to" → "Gonna"

Stress and Intonation

Important words are stressed (said louder and clearer)

"This PARTY is LIT!" (stress "party" and "lit")

"Your OUTFIT is FIRE!" (stress "outfit" and "fire")

APPENDIX E: CULTURAL NOTES

Understanding American Teen Culture

Social Media

Instagram, TikTok, and Snapchat are the most popular platforms

"Posting on the story" means sharing temporary content

"Scrolling" is a common activity in free time

High School

Freshman, sophomore, junior, senior are the four years

The "halls" are where social life happens

"Pop quizzes" are surprise tests

Friendship

Loyalty is highly valued

"Ride or die" friends are the most trusted

"Hyping up" friends is common

Money

"Hustling" means working hard to make money

Part time jobs are common for teenagers

"Side gigs" are extra jobs for more money

Music and Entertainment

Binge watching shows is popular

Concerts are a big deal

"Bangers" are popular songs

Respect

Avoid using offensive language

Be respectful of others even when using slang

Some slang comes from specific communities use it respectfully

FINAL WORDS FROM THE AUTHOR

You Got This, Fam!

Learning American slang is a journey, and you've just taken a huge step! Whether you want to understand American movies, talk to friends, or sound more natural when you speak English, this book has given you the tools you need.

Remember:

1. Practice every day! Even just 5 minutes makes a difference.
2. Speak out loud! Slang is spoken language you have to say it to learn it.
3. Find a friend to practice with! Learning together is more fun.
4. Make mistakes! That's how you learn. Don't be afraid.
5. Keep a slang journal! Write down new words you learn.

The most important thing is to keep going. Slang changes all the time, so don't worry about knowing everything. Just keep learning, keep practicing, and keep having fun with English!

You got this!

With gratitude,

The Author:

Yasin Awal Hasan

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Urban Dictionary – urbandictionary.com (use critically)

Oxford English Dictionary – oed.com

Cambridge Dictionary – dictionary.cambridge.org

BBC Learning English – bbc.co.uk/learningenglish

VOA Learning English – learningenglish.voanews.com

British Council Learn English Teens – learnenglishteens.britishcouncil.org

Slang changes fast. The best way to stay current is to keep listening—to music, to shows, to real conversations—and to keep practicing out loud with people you trust.

You got this, fam.

— End of Book —